Book of Centuries

Book I: The Oldest Times to the Birth of Christ

Kept by _____

Begun _____

Notes From Another Mother

To the Keeper of this Book

This little book goes with you to the museum, so that what you see there may “all remain distinct and clear in your memory.”

Each opening is one hundred years: the ruled page on the left is for writing, the plain page on the right for drawing. This first book runs from the oldest times to the birth of Christ; the second book goes on from there.

Every ruled line stands for five years, and the little dots mark the single years. The figures at the end of the lines count the years of the century; before Christ they count backwards, so the last years before Christ are at the foot of the page. Write a name or a thing on its line, in its place along the line.

On the plain page opposite, draw something you have seen from that century, carefully, as it really is.

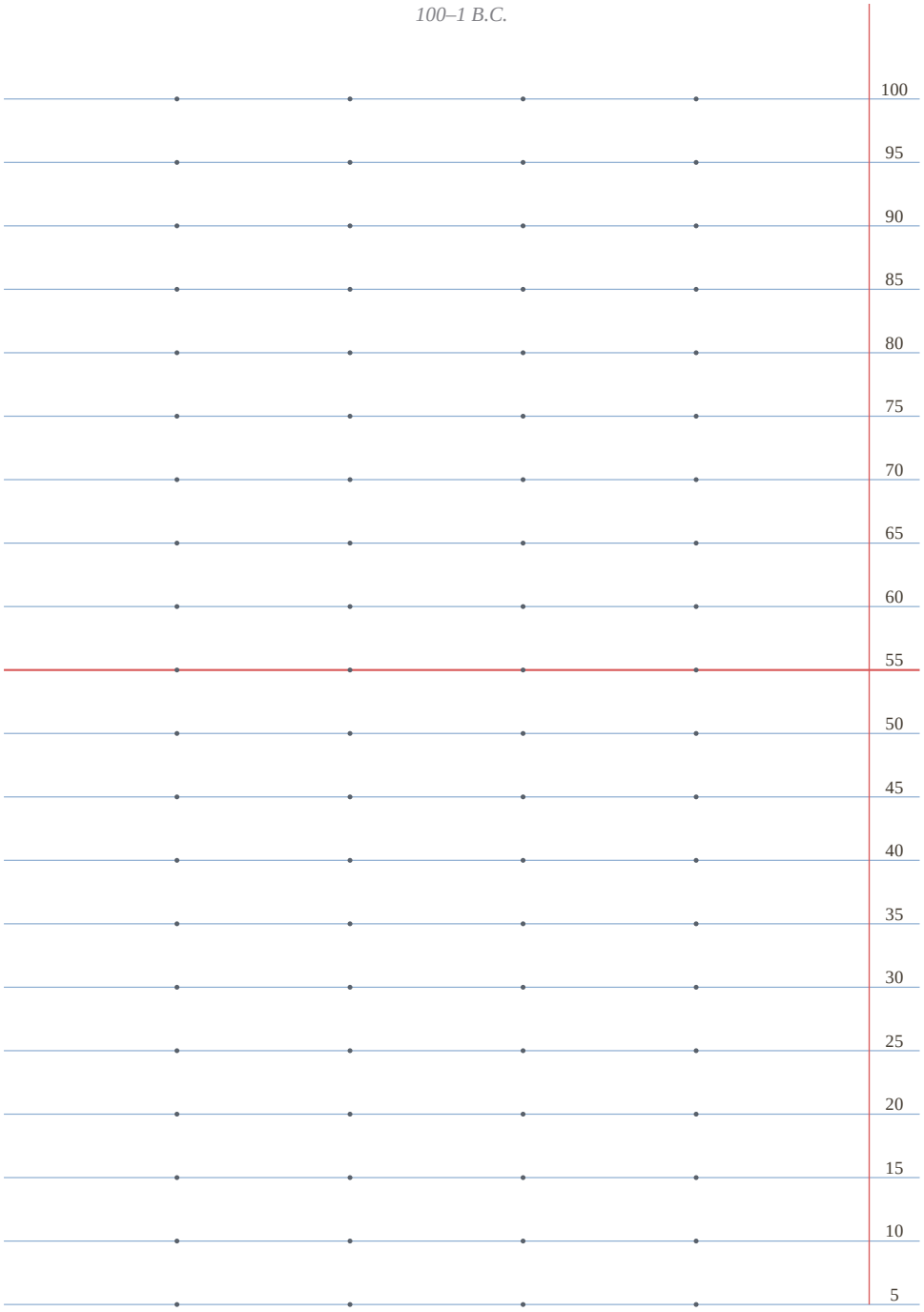
Some pages may stay empty for a long time. Little by little, as you visit and read, you will fill them.

One century to each opening, a plain page for drawing facing a ruled page for writing, as in the interleaved Books of Centuries the P.U.S. children kept from 1914 (G. M. Bernau). A page for each hundred years, forty-five before Christ and twenty-one after, as in Mrs. Epps’s museum note-book (The Parents’ Review, 1906).

Before History and Dates Began

1st Century, B.C.

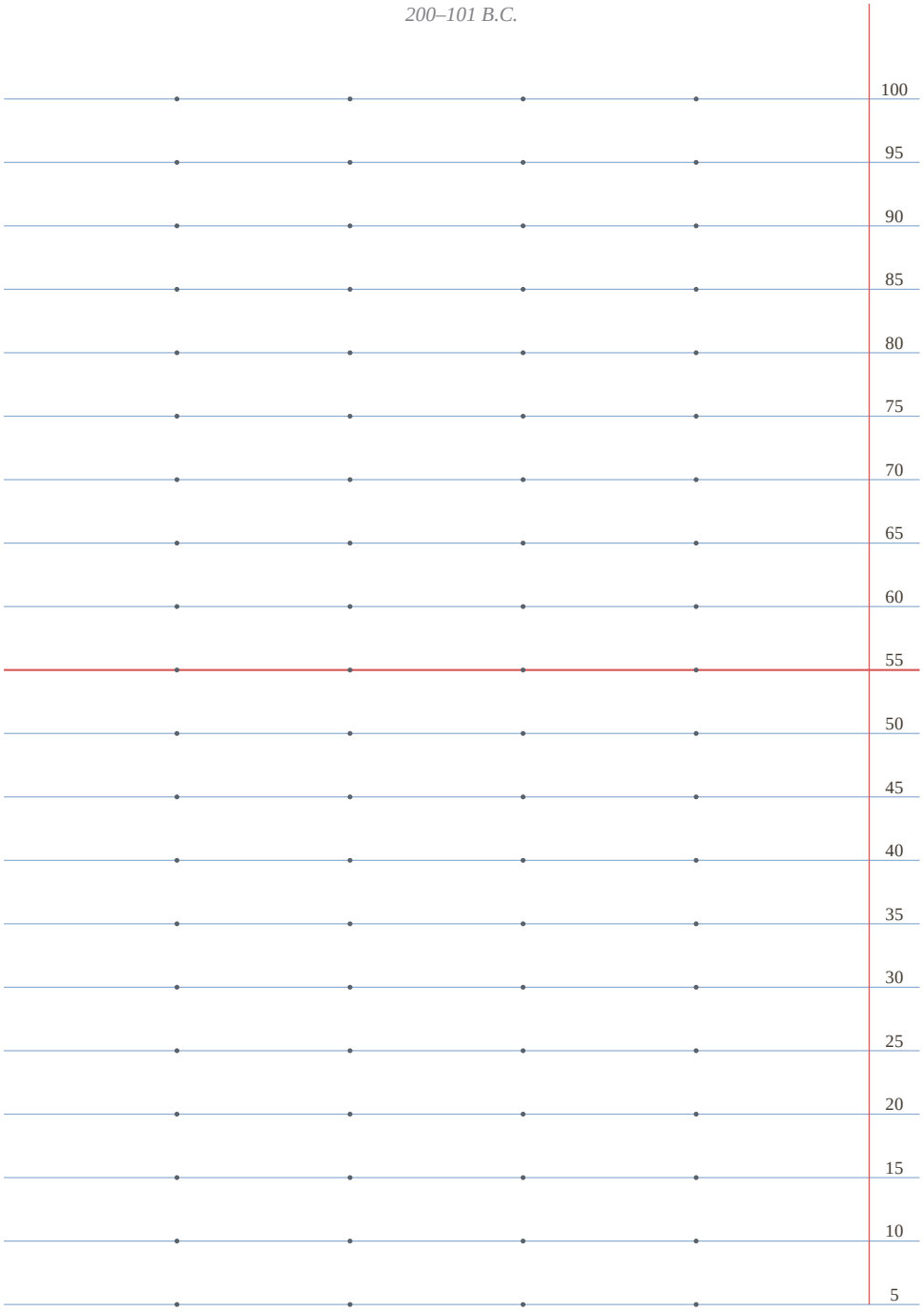
100–1 B.C.



Before History and Dates Began

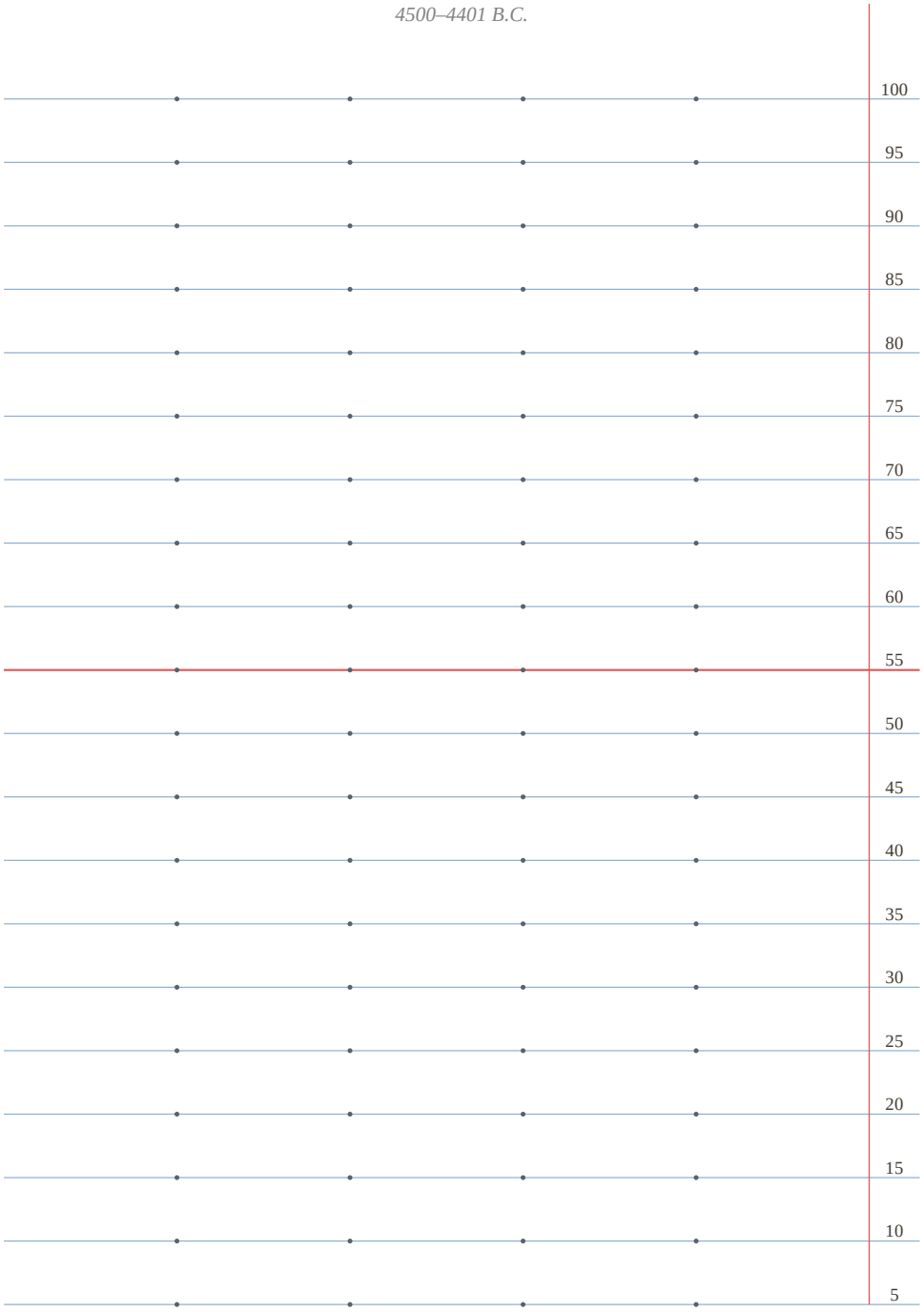
2nd Century, B.C.

200–101 B.C.



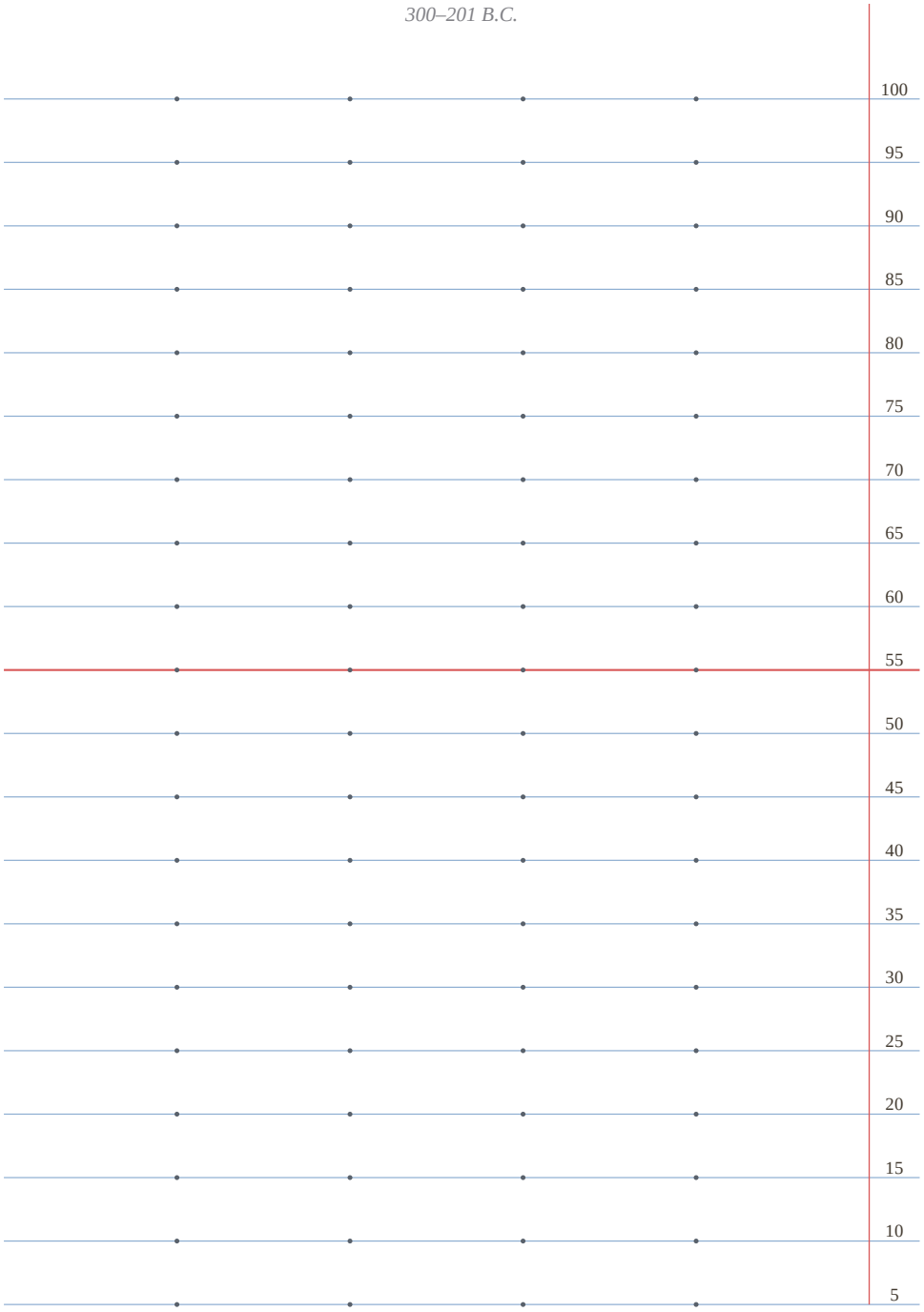
45th Century, B.C.

4500–4401 B.C.



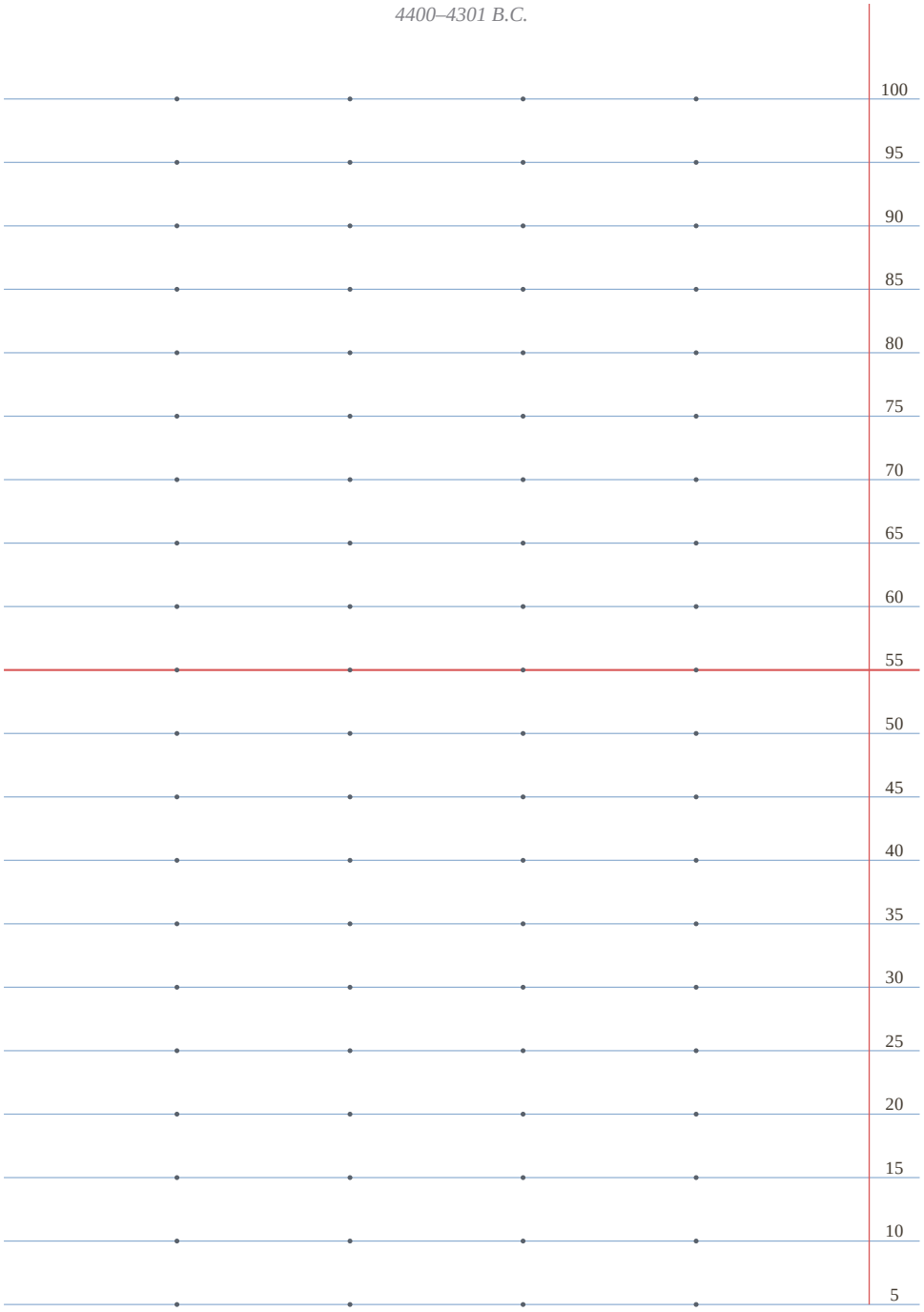
3rd Century, B.C.

300–201 B.C.



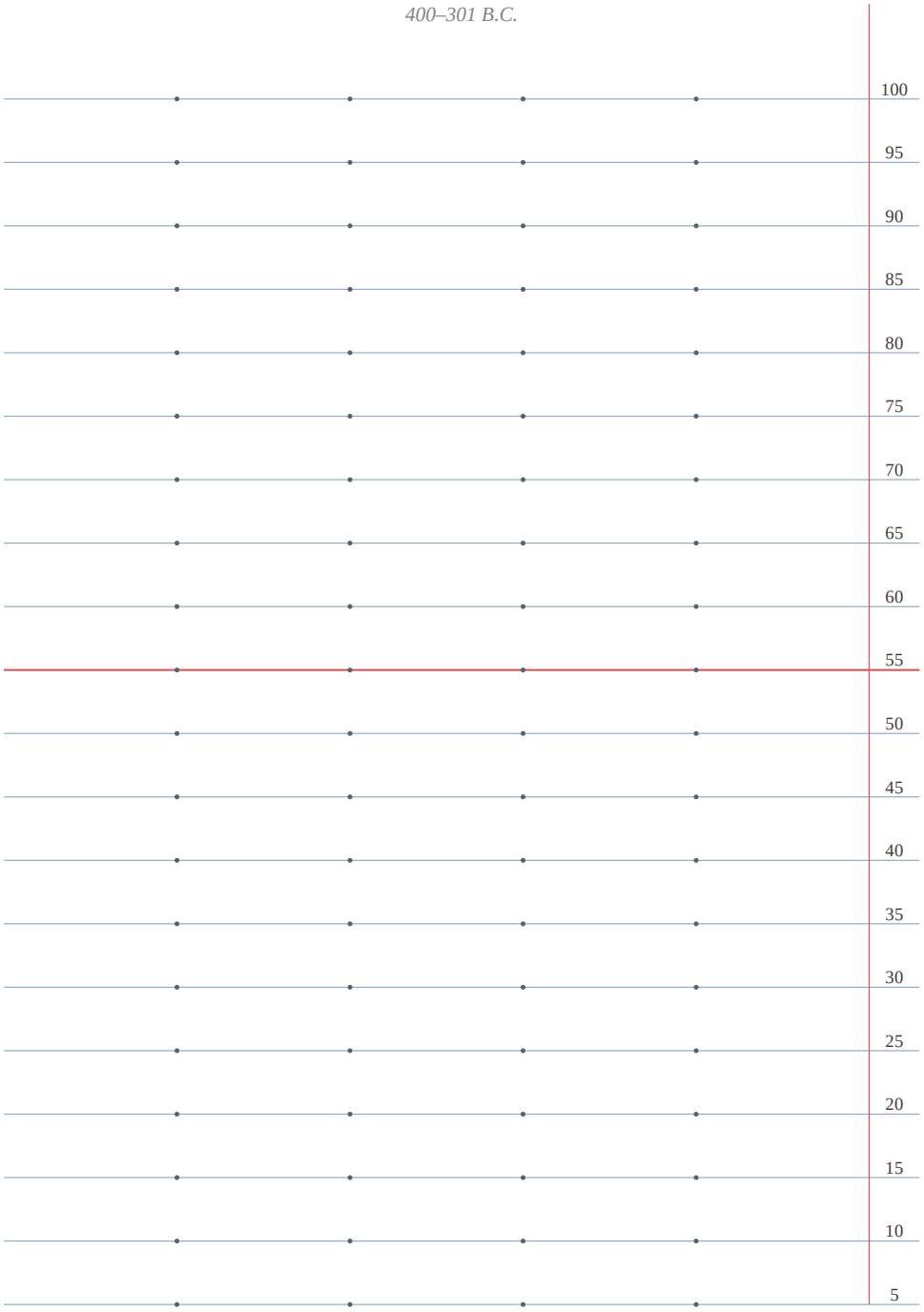
44th Century, B.C.

4400–4301 B.C.



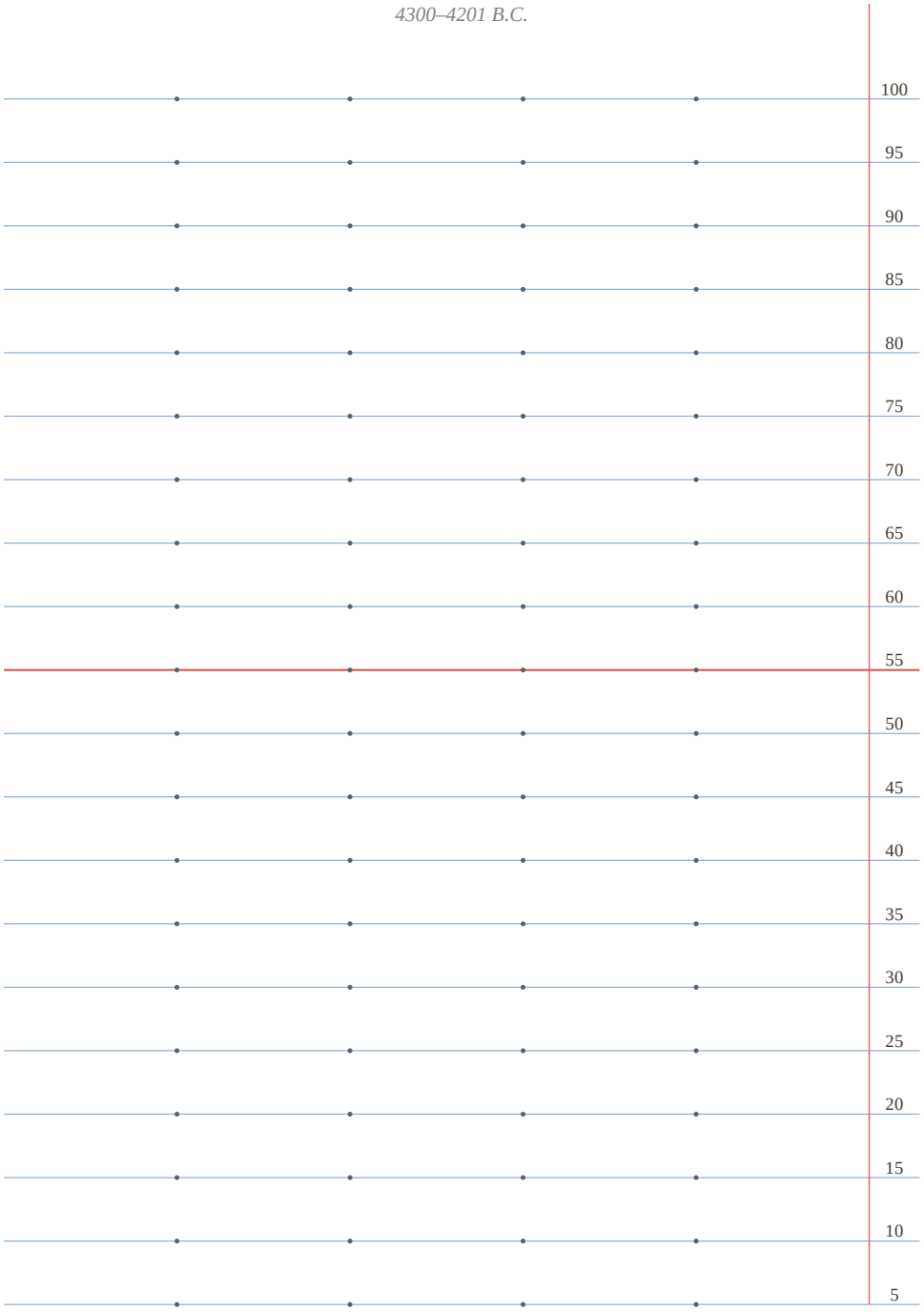
4th Century, B.C.

400–301 B.C.



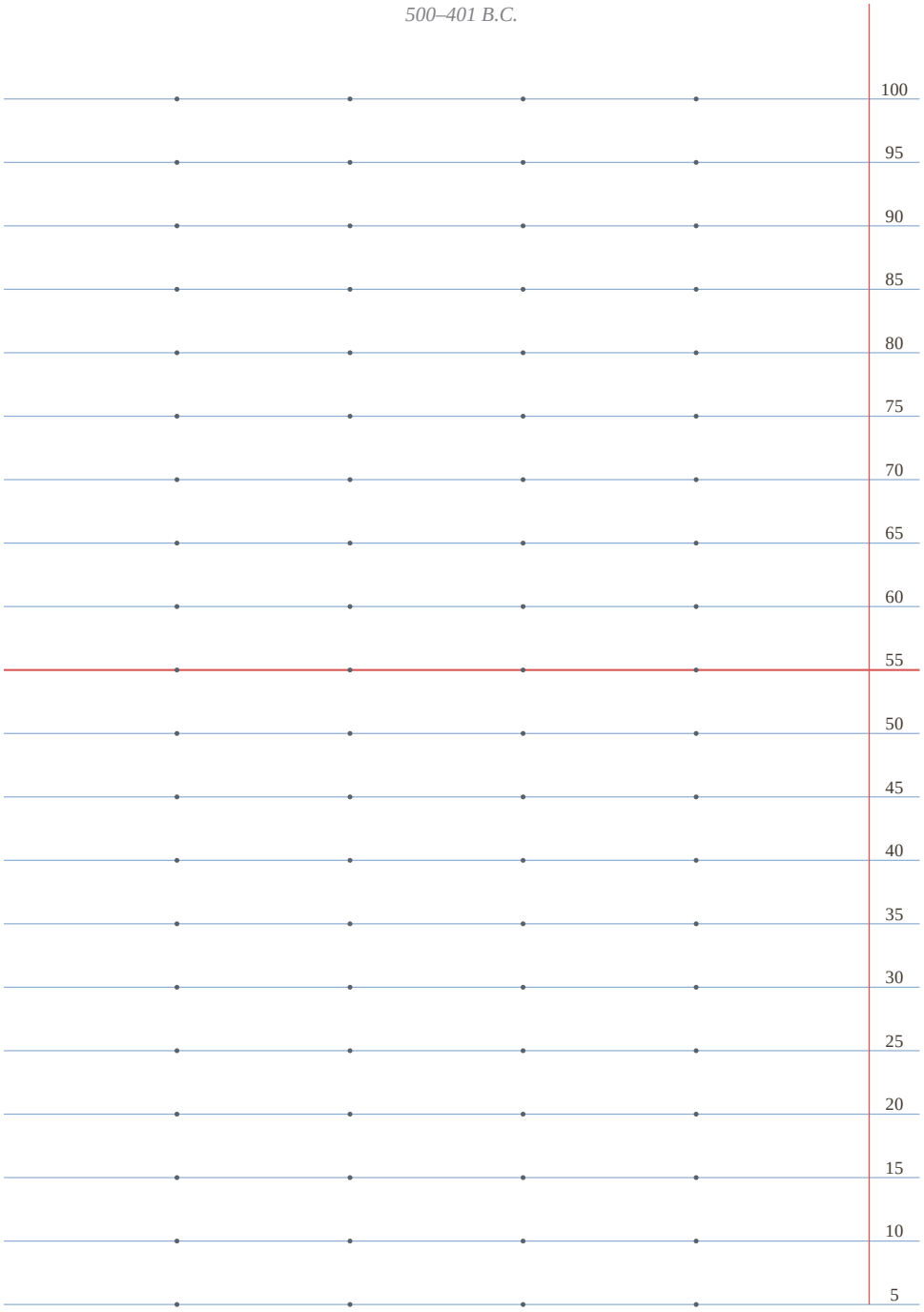
43rd Century, B.C.

4300–4201 B.C.



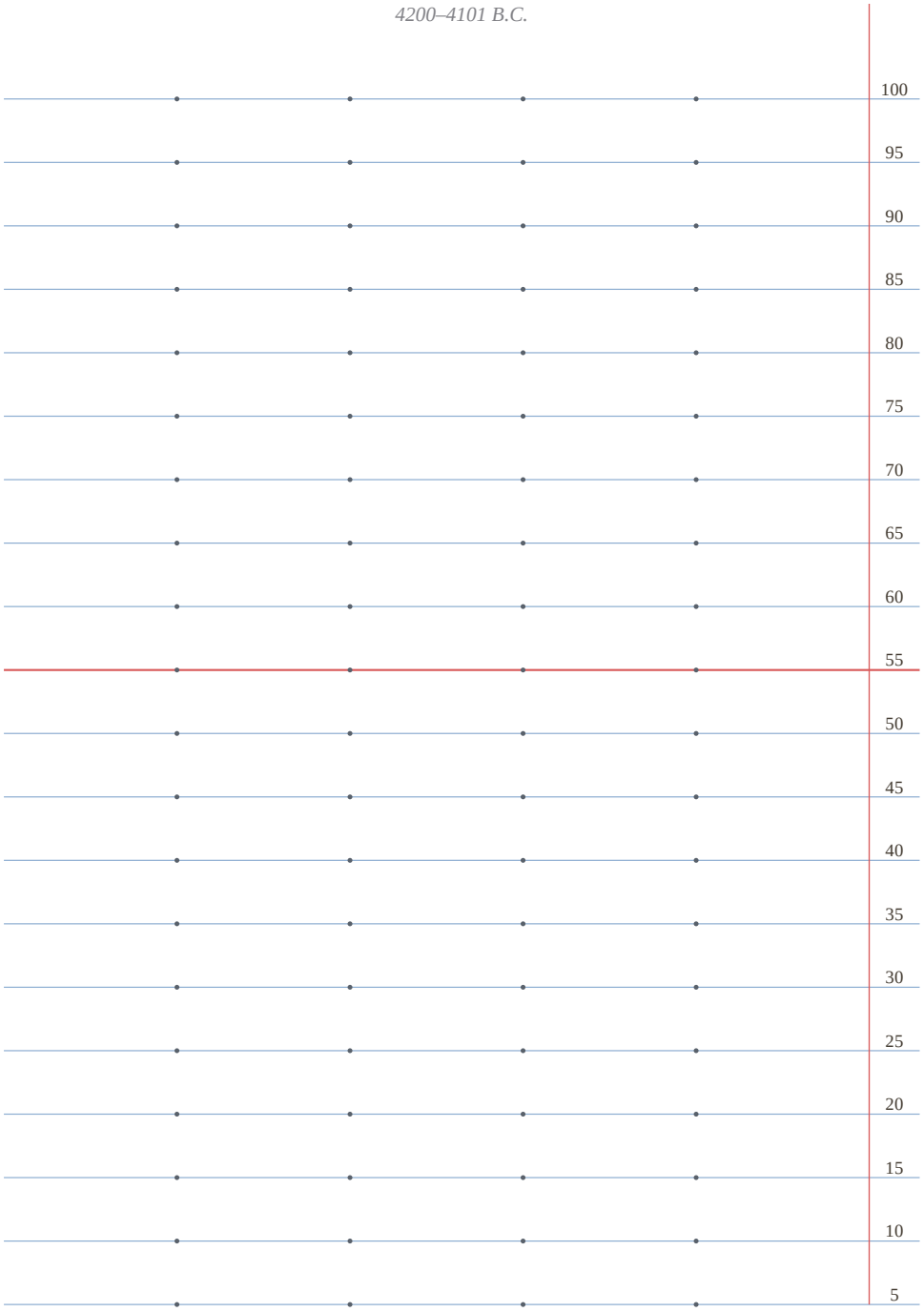
5th Century, B.C.

500–401 B.C.



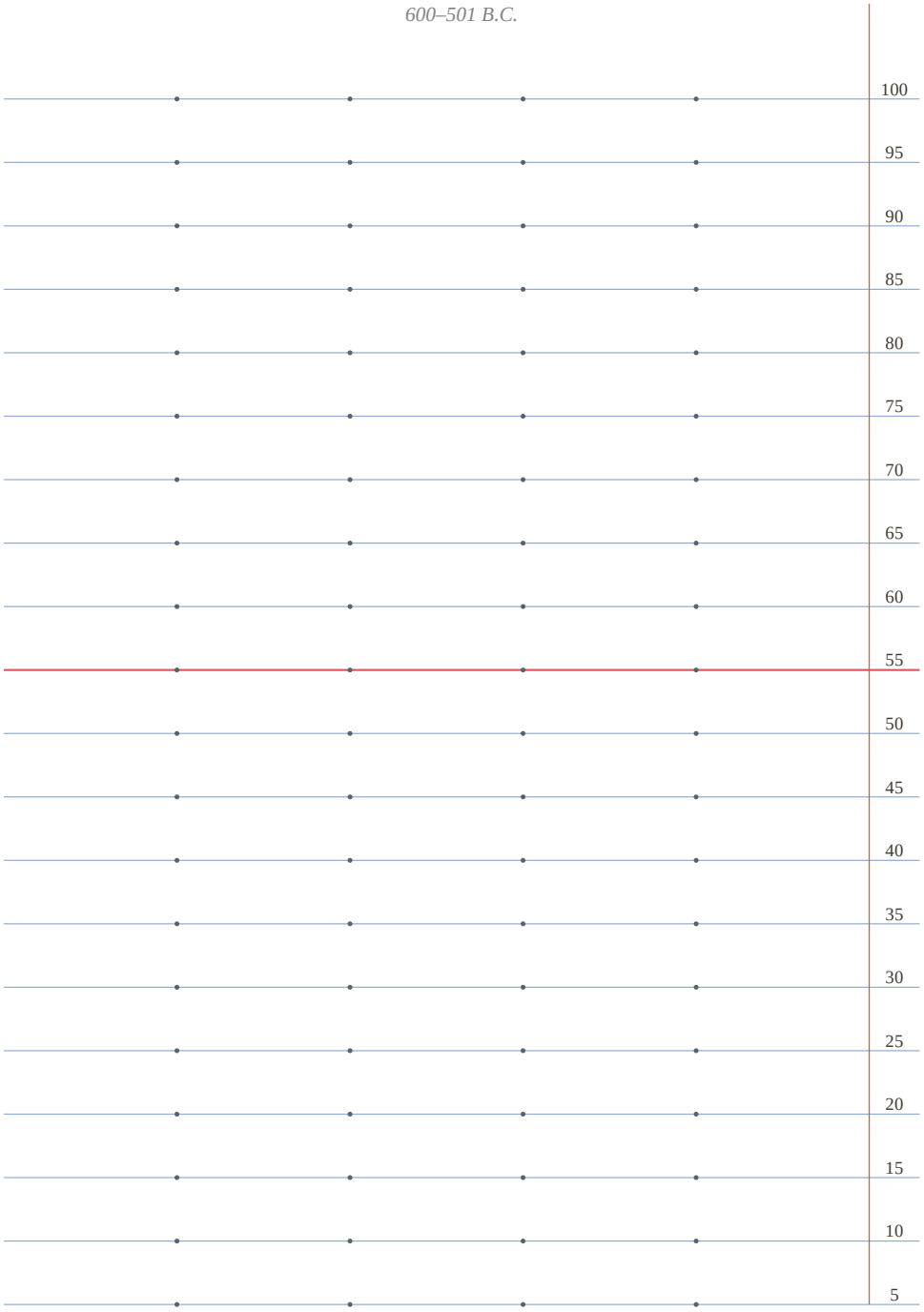
42nd Century, B.C.

4200–4101 B.C.



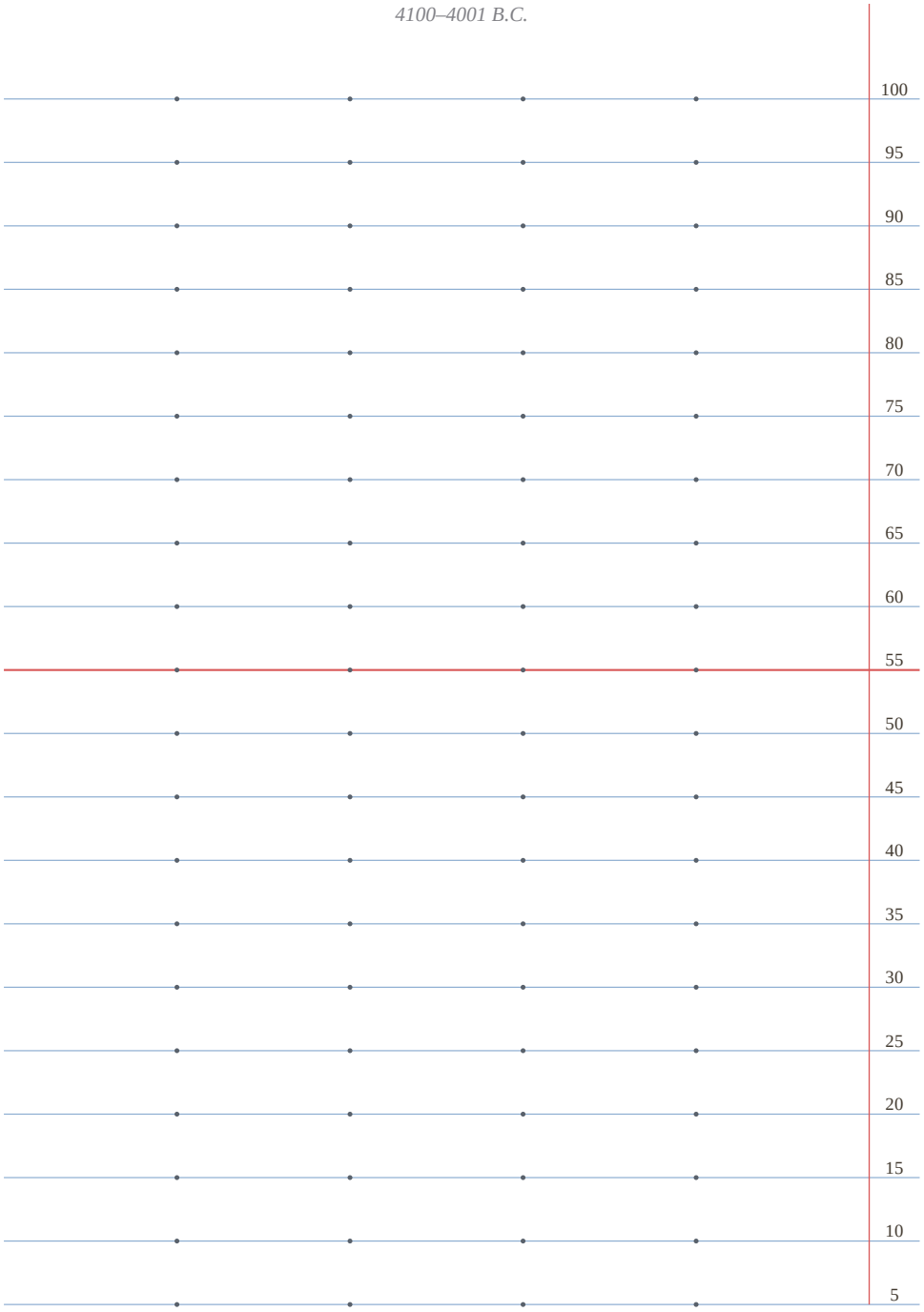
6th Century, B.C.

600–501 B.C.



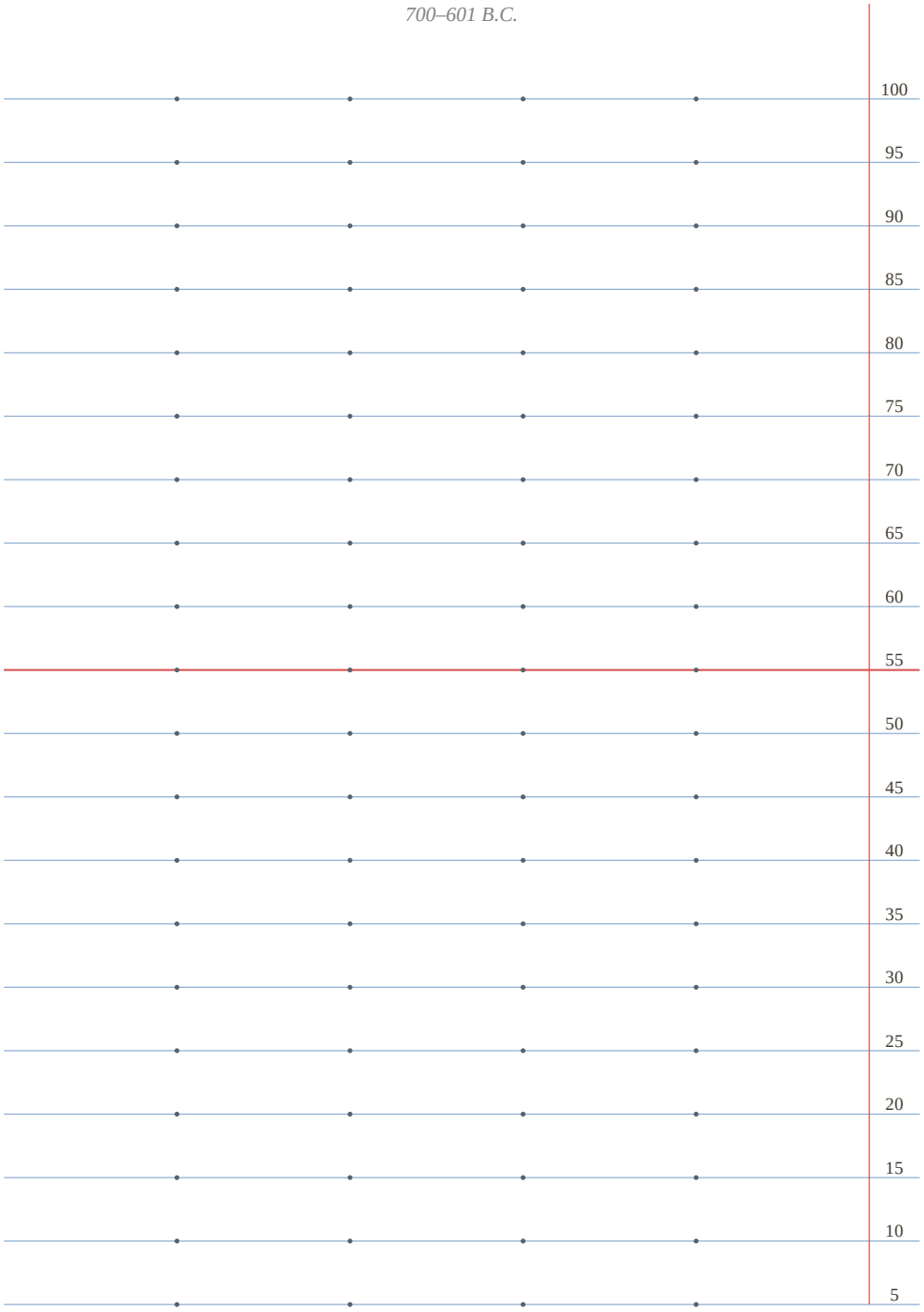
41st Century, B.C.

4100–4001 B.C.



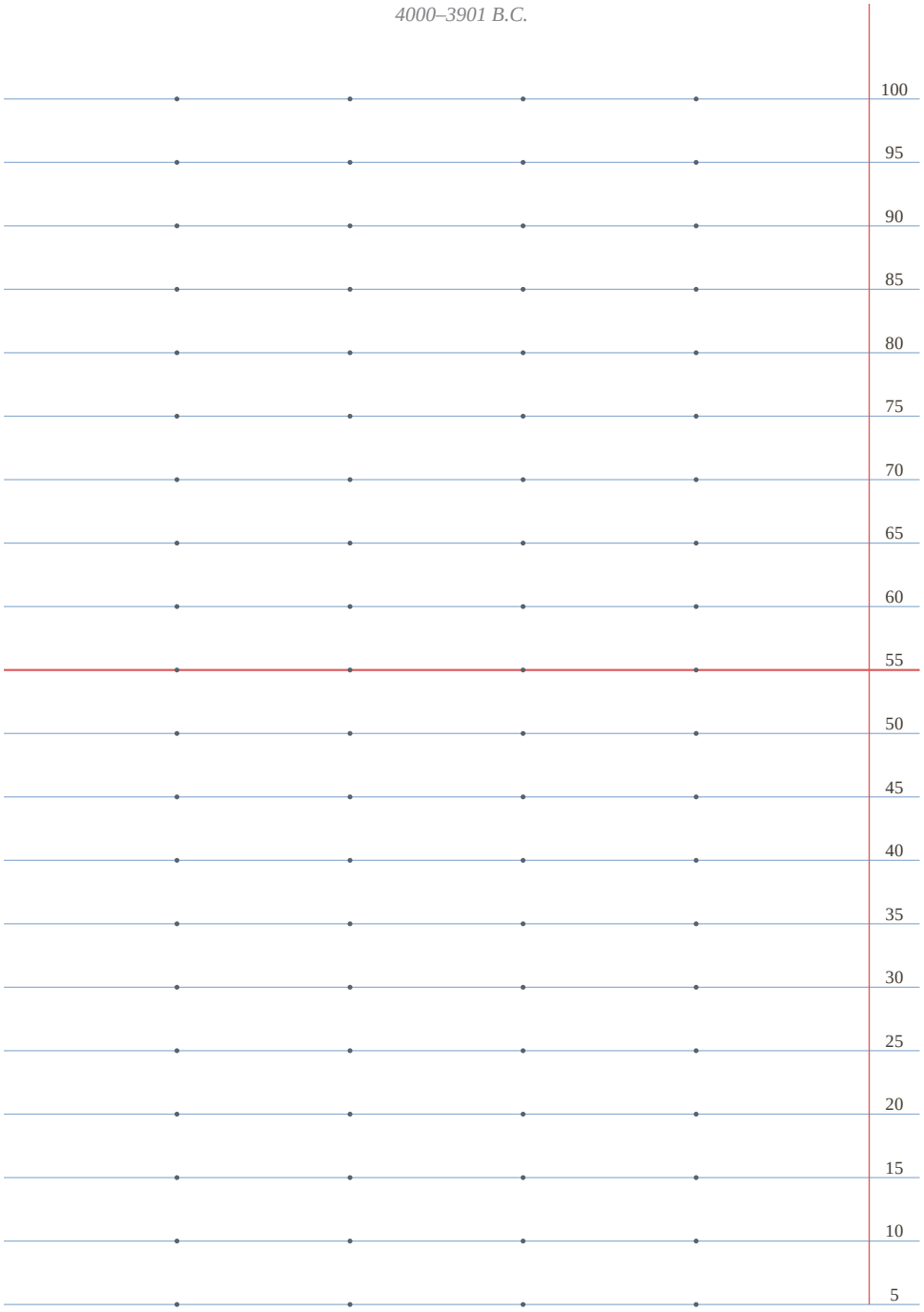
7th Century, B.C.

700–601 B.C.



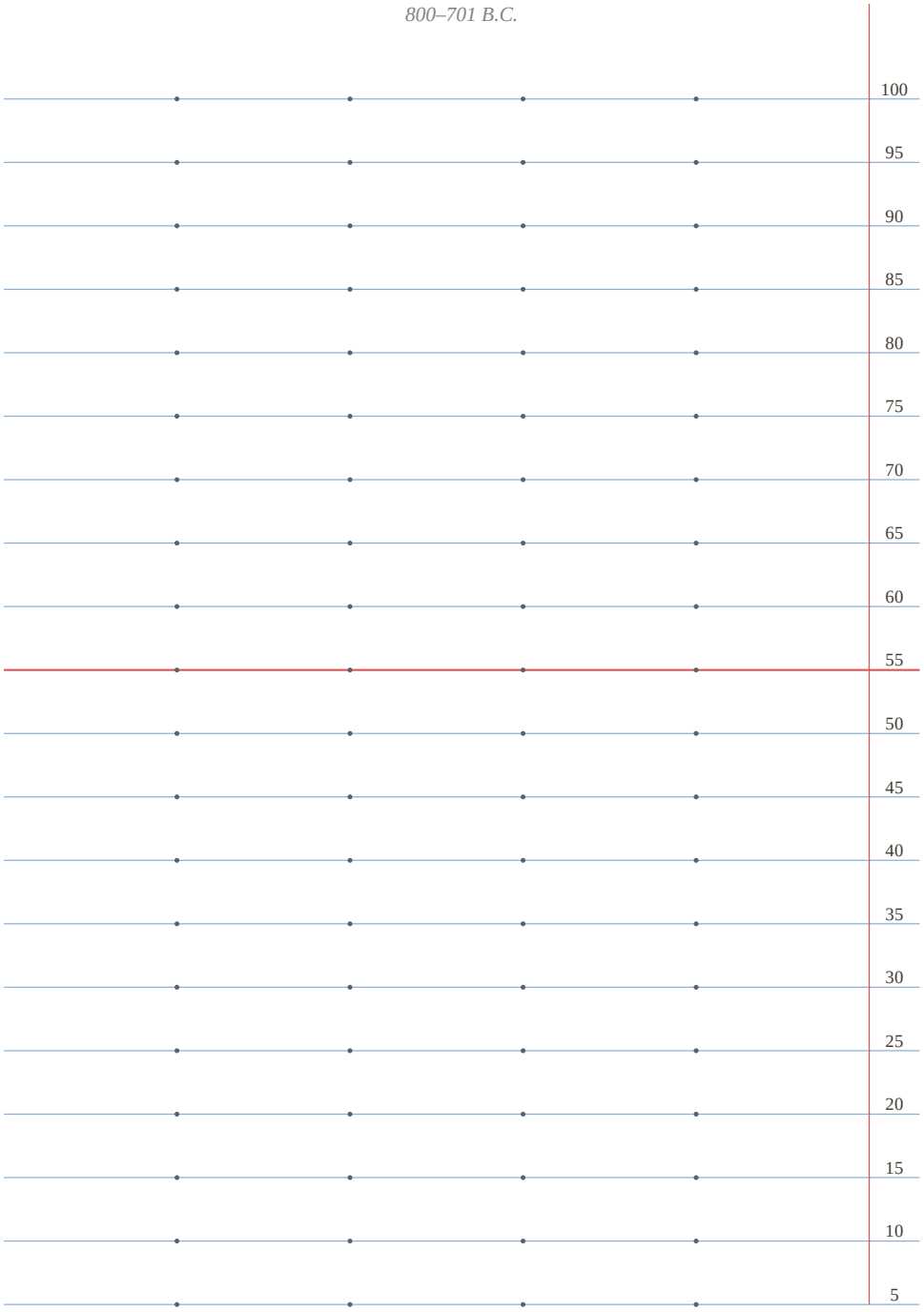
40th Century, B.C.

4000–3901 B.C.



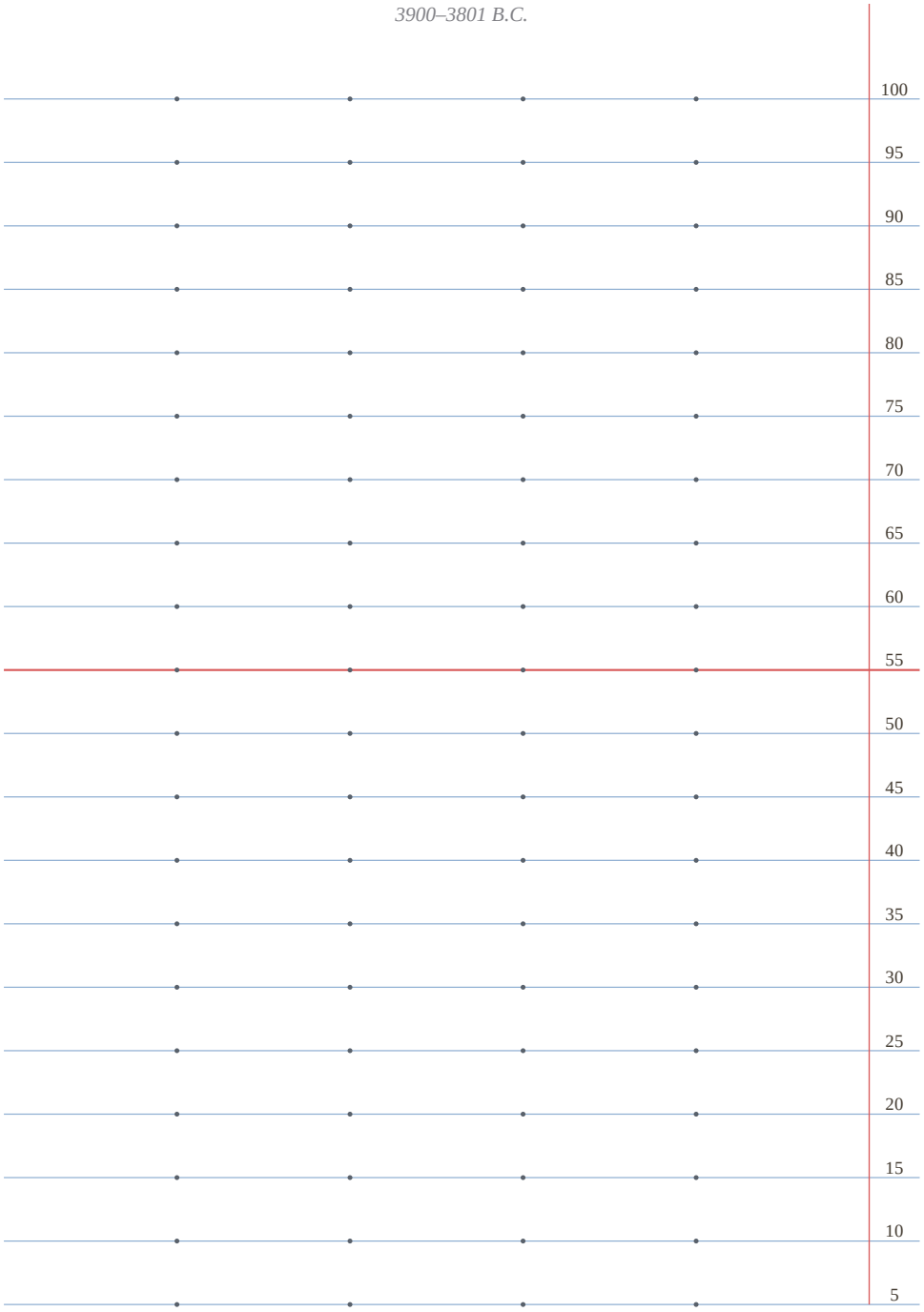
8th Century, B.C.

800–701 B.C.



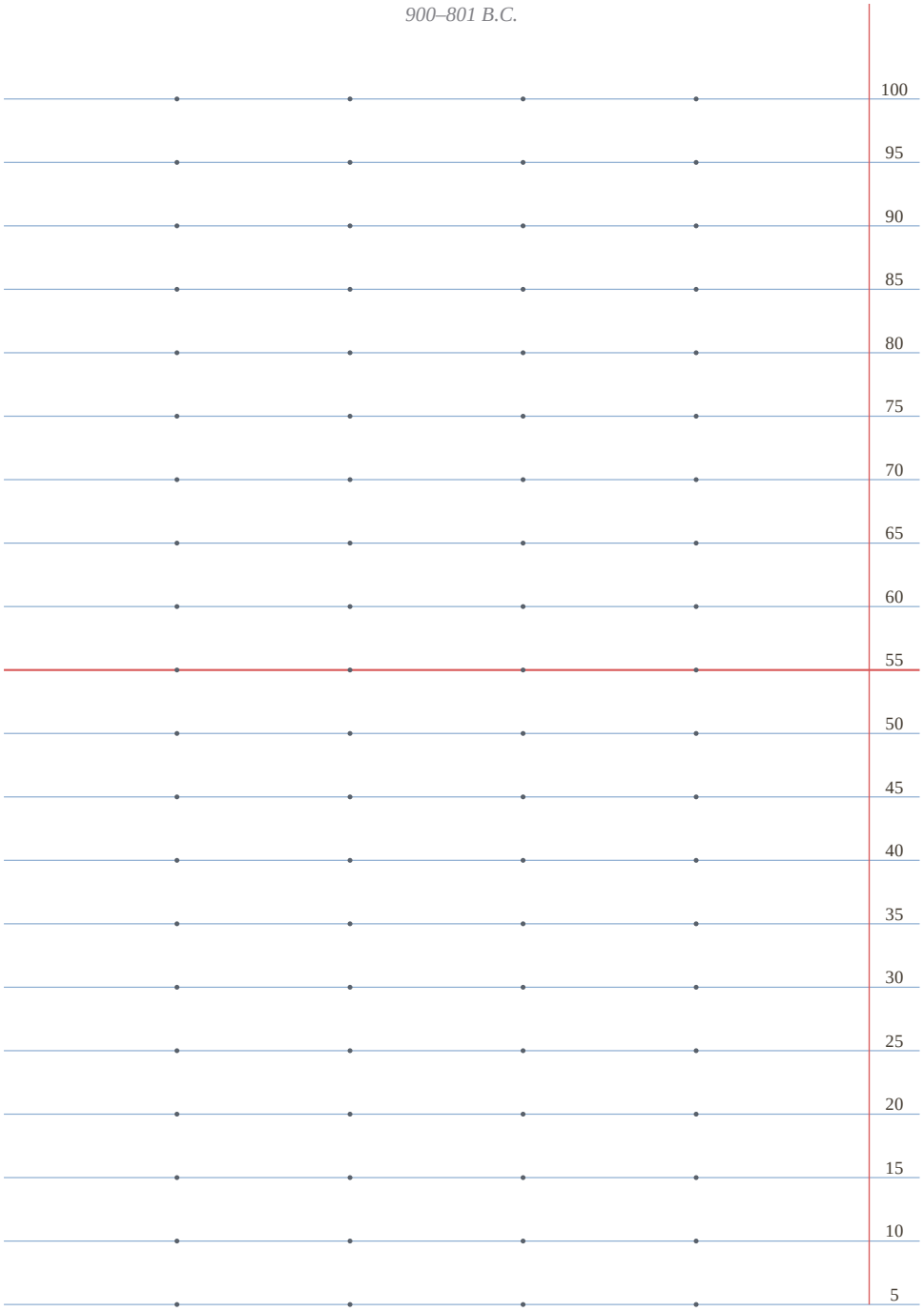
39th Century, B.C.

3900–3801 B.C.



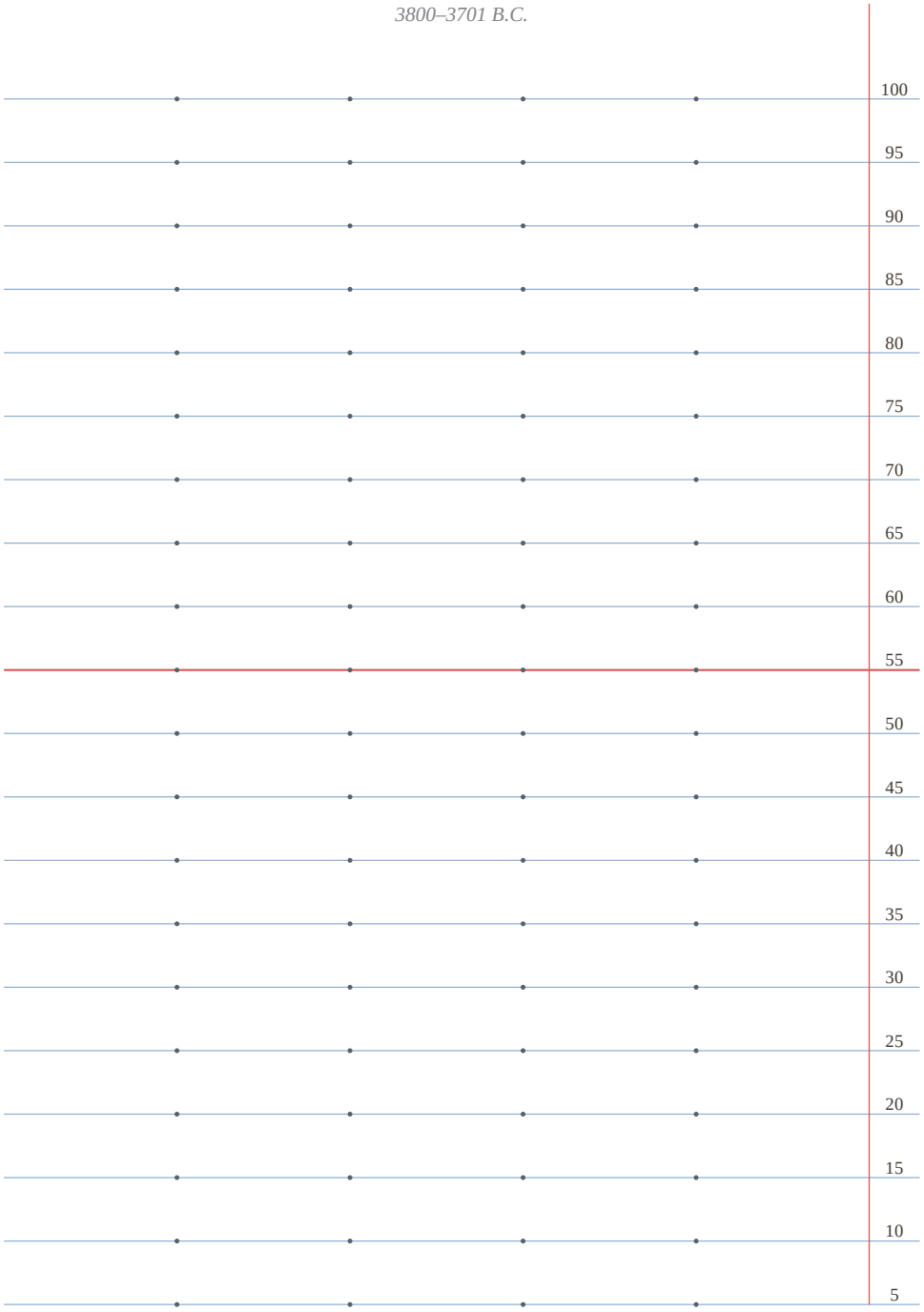
9th Century, B.C.

900–801 B.C.



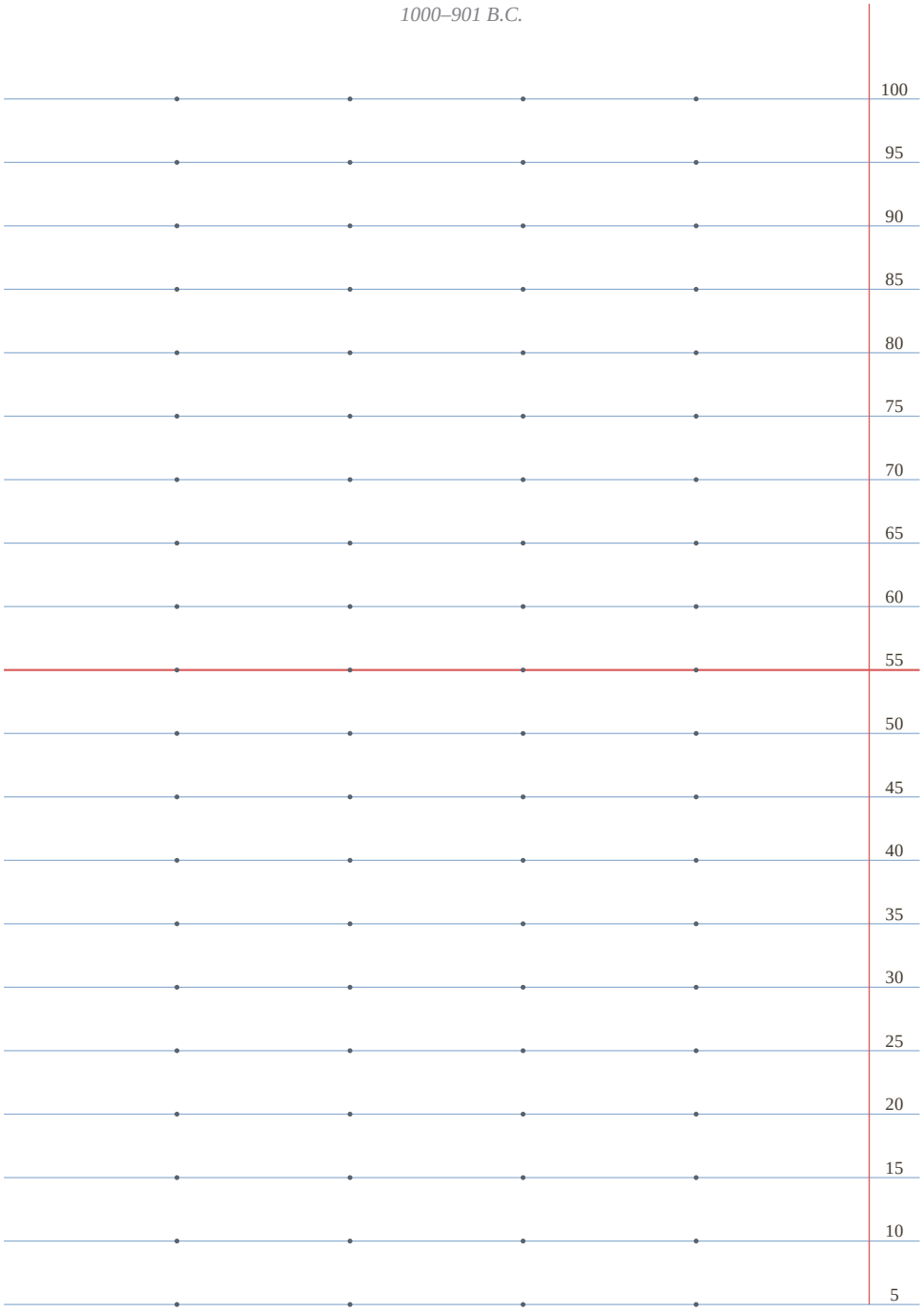
38th Century, B.C.

3800–3701 B.C.



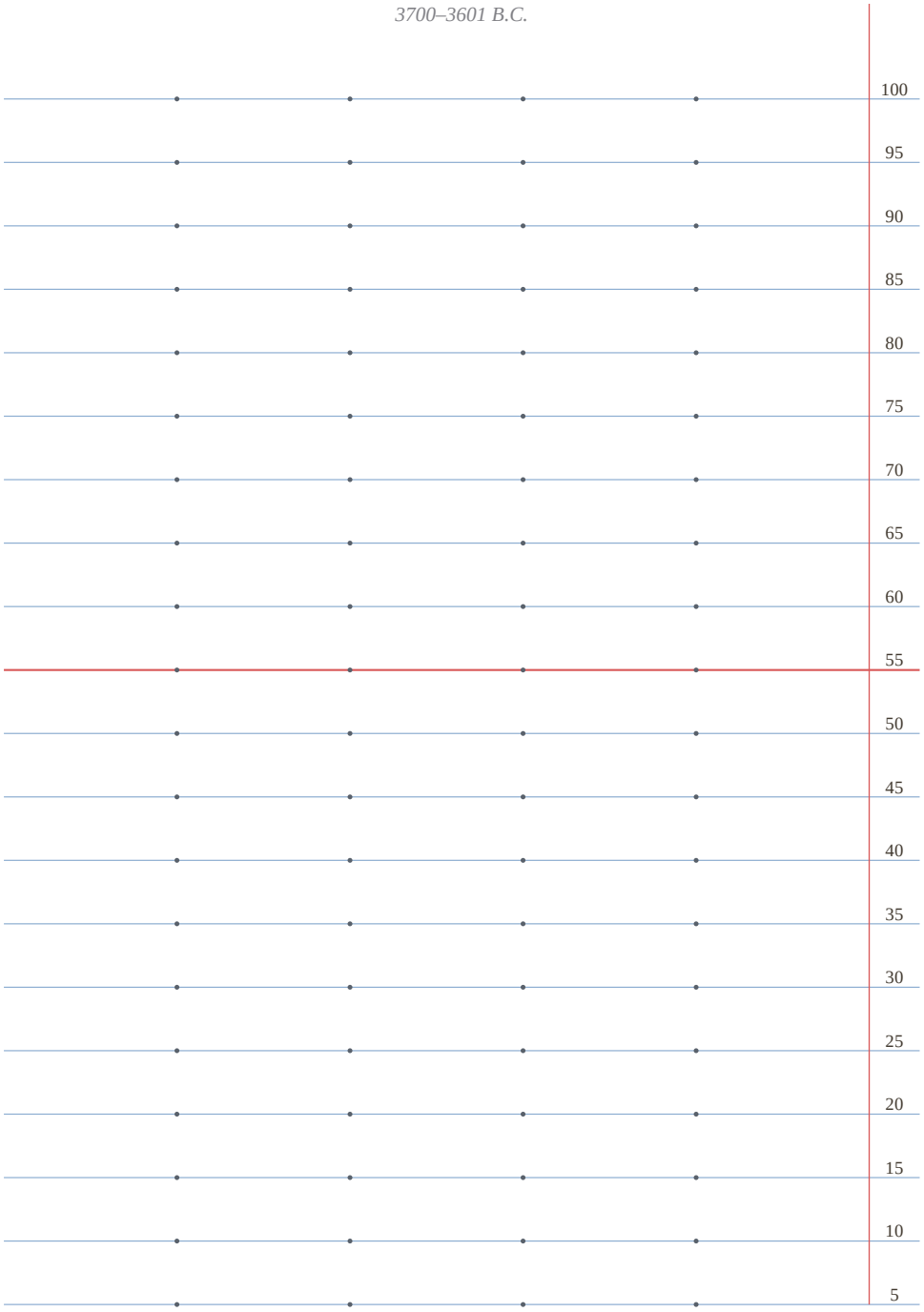
10th Century, B.C.

1000–901 B.C.



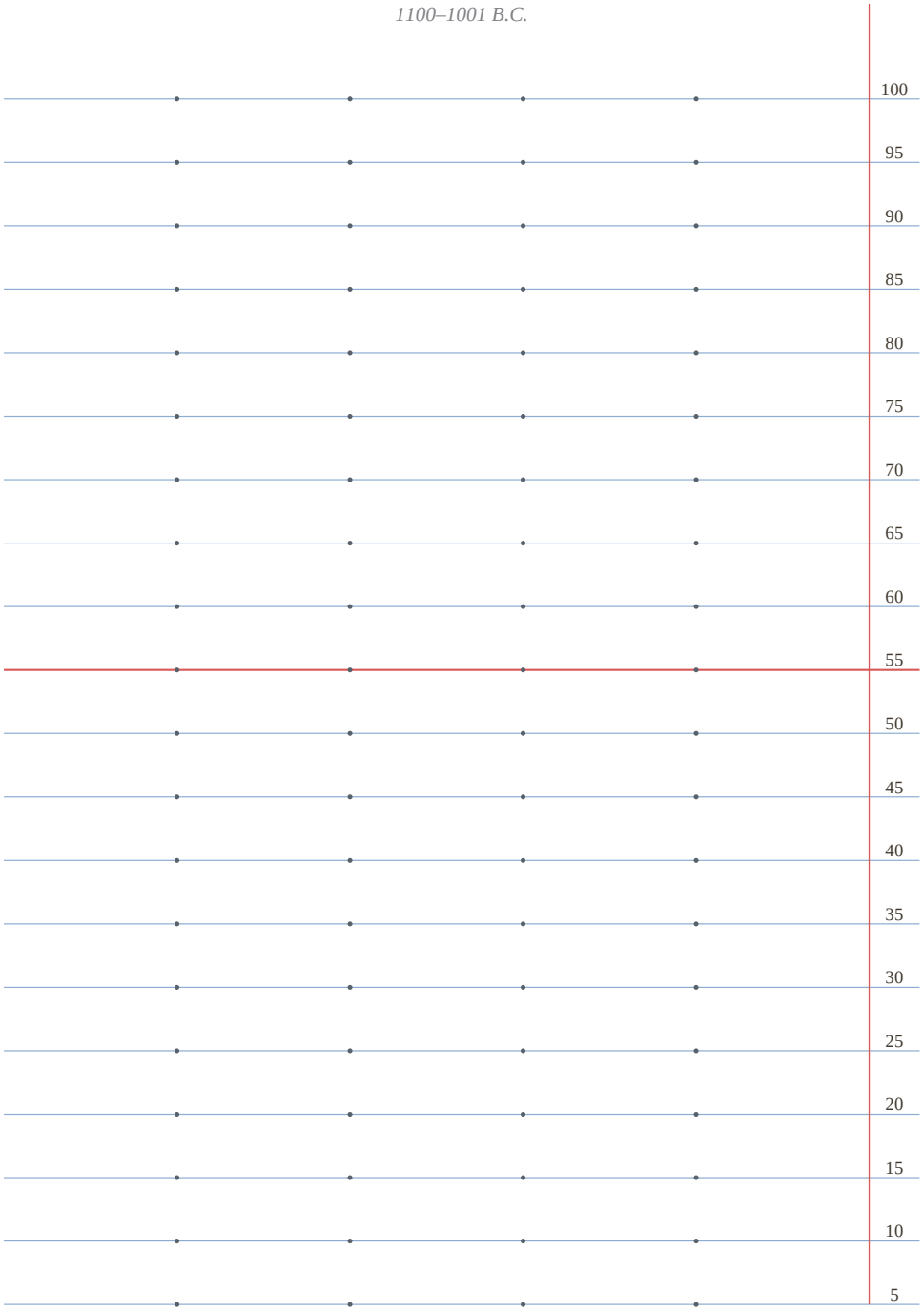
37th Century, B.C.

3700–3601 B.C.



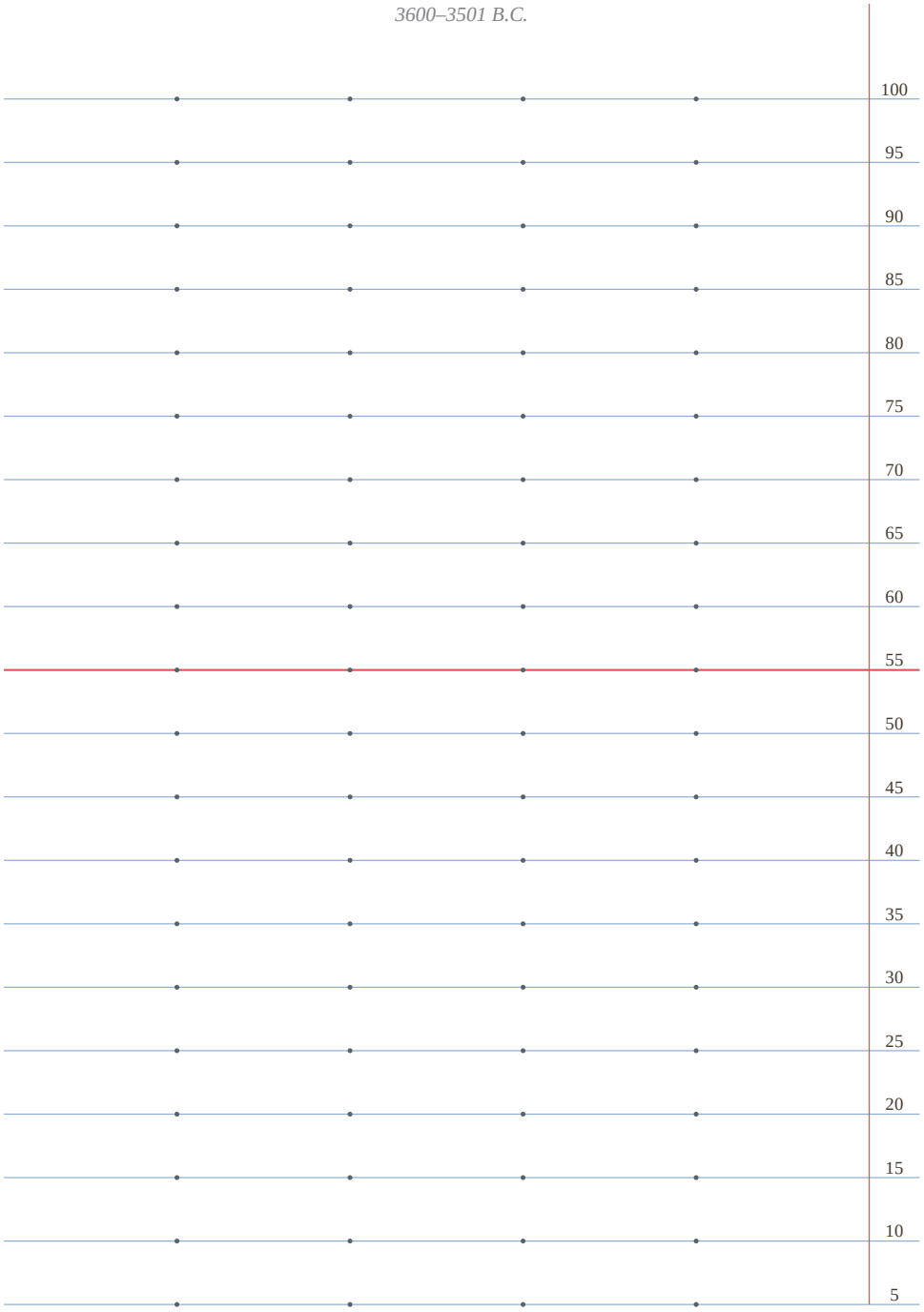
11th Century, B.C.

1100–1001 B.C.



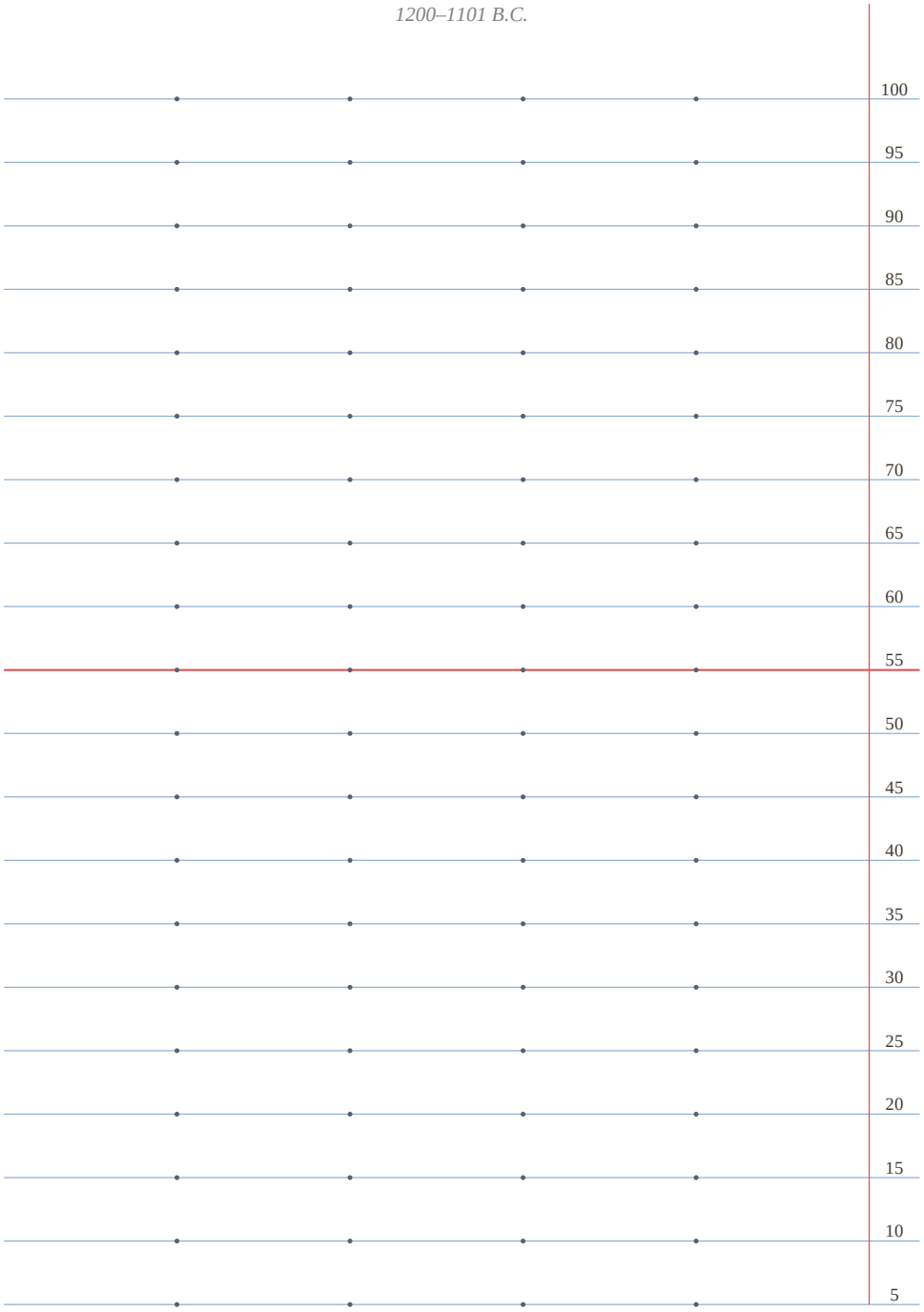
36th Century, B.C.

3600–3501 B.C.



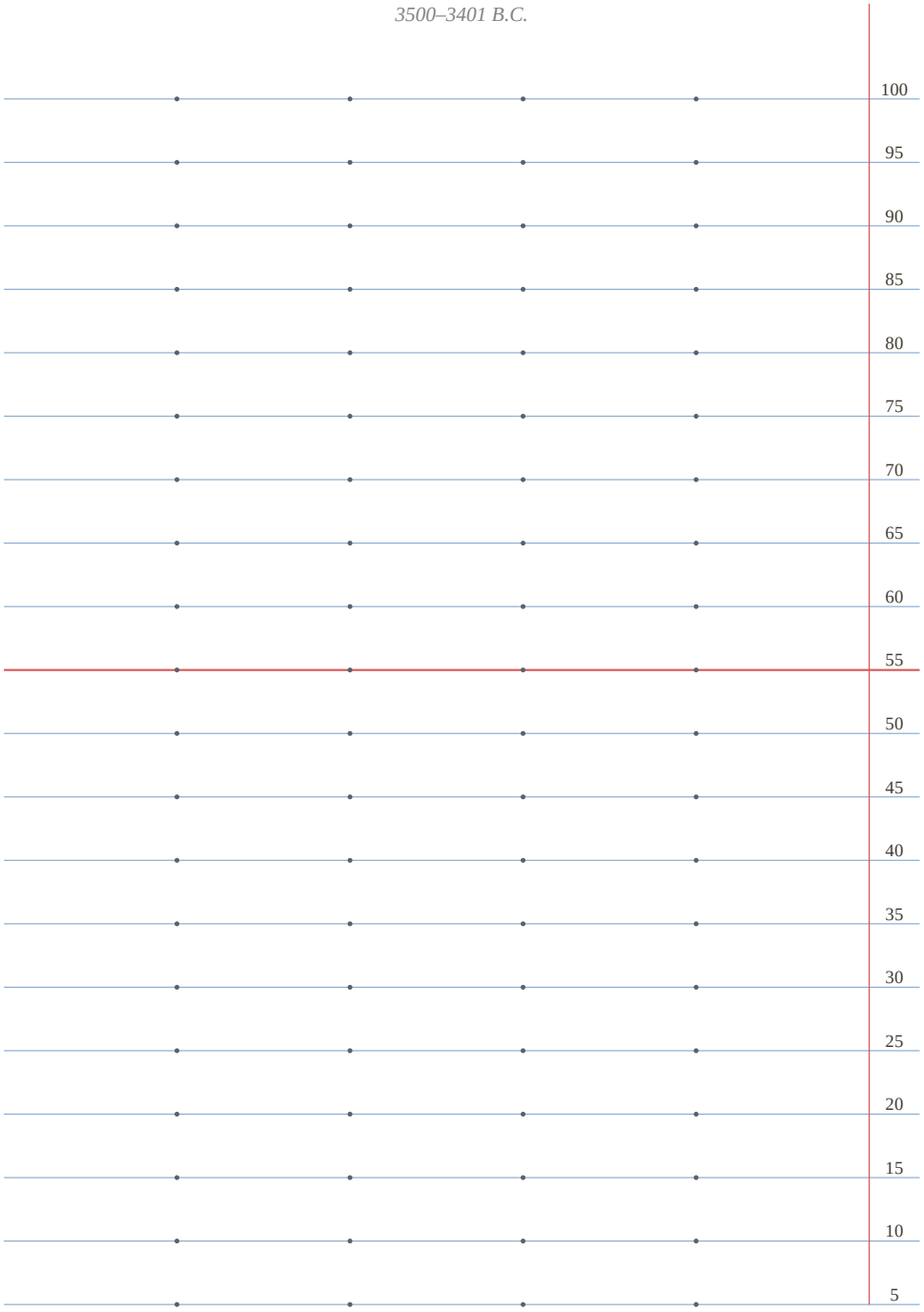
12th Century, B.C.

1200–1101 B.C.



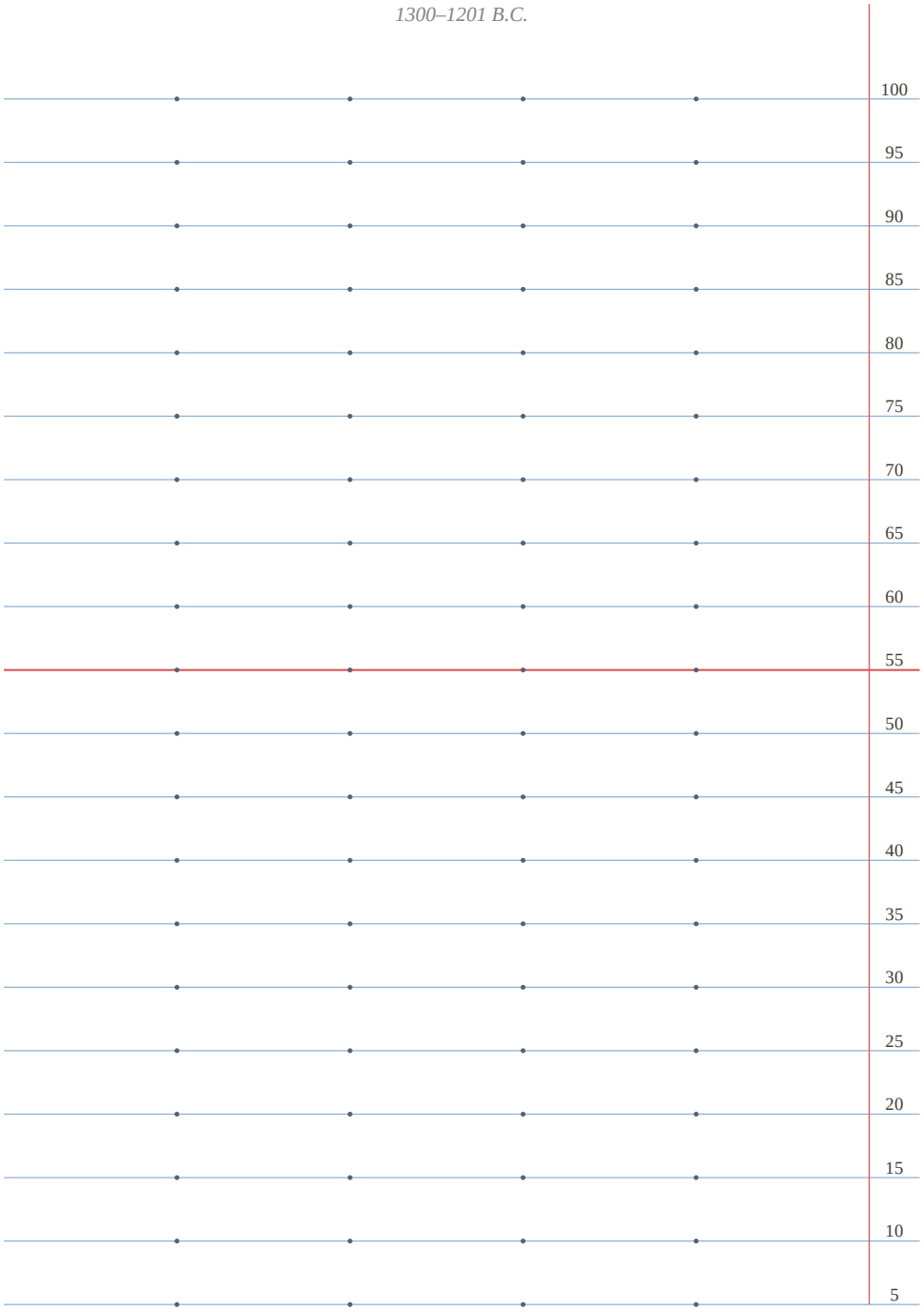
35th Century, B.C.

3500–3401 B.C.



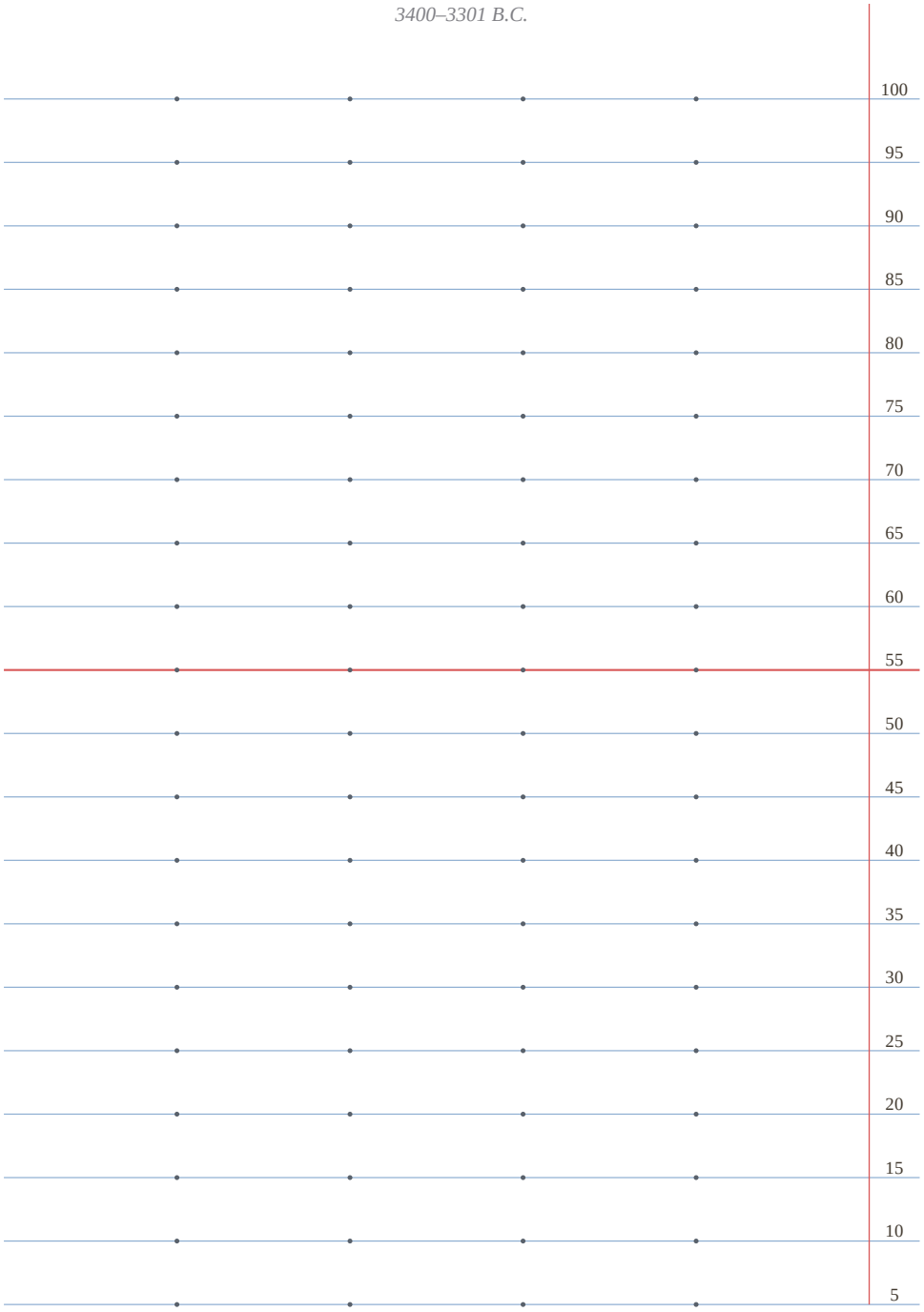
13th Century, B.C.

1300–1201 B.C.



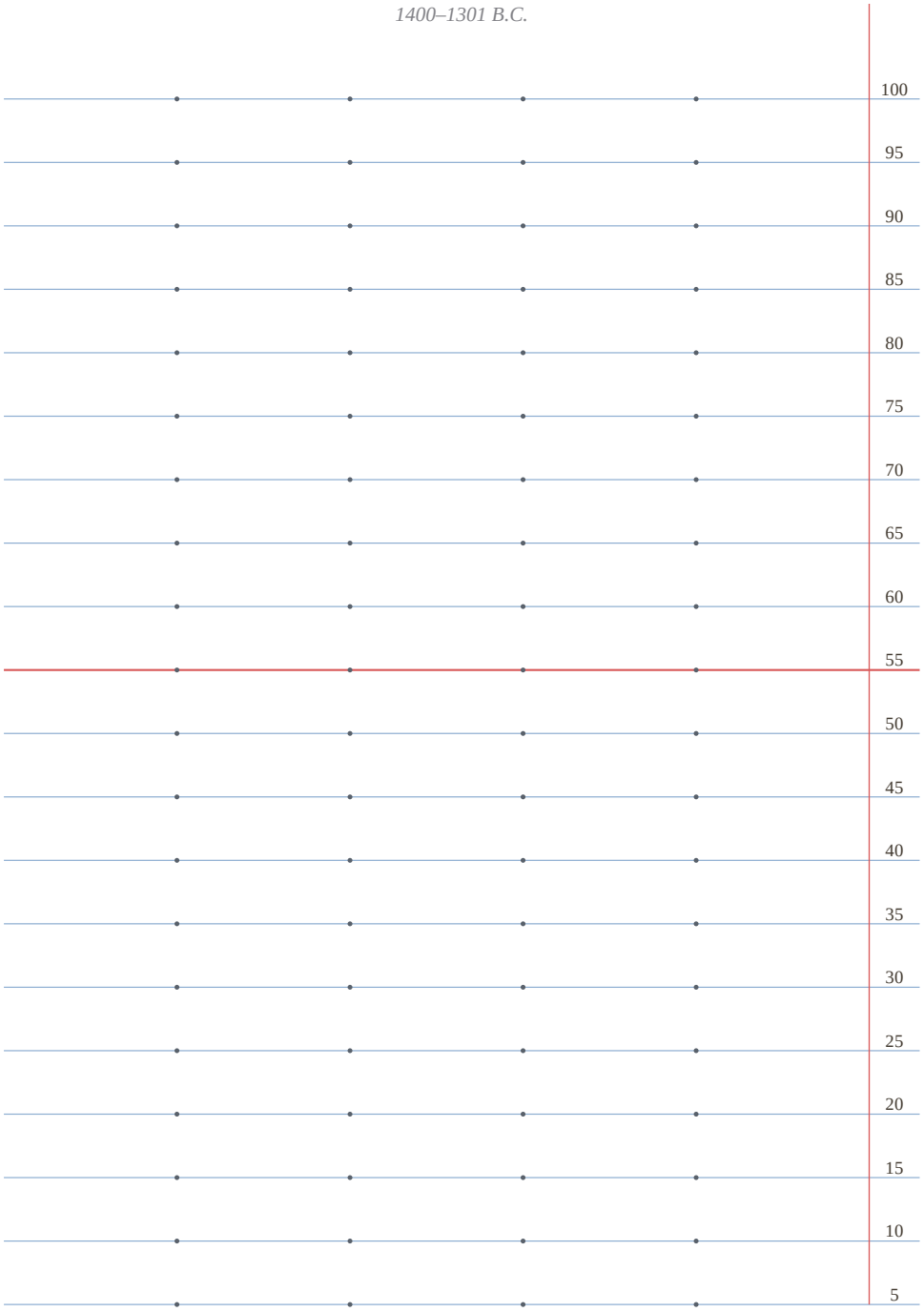
34th Century, B.C.

3400–3301 B.C.



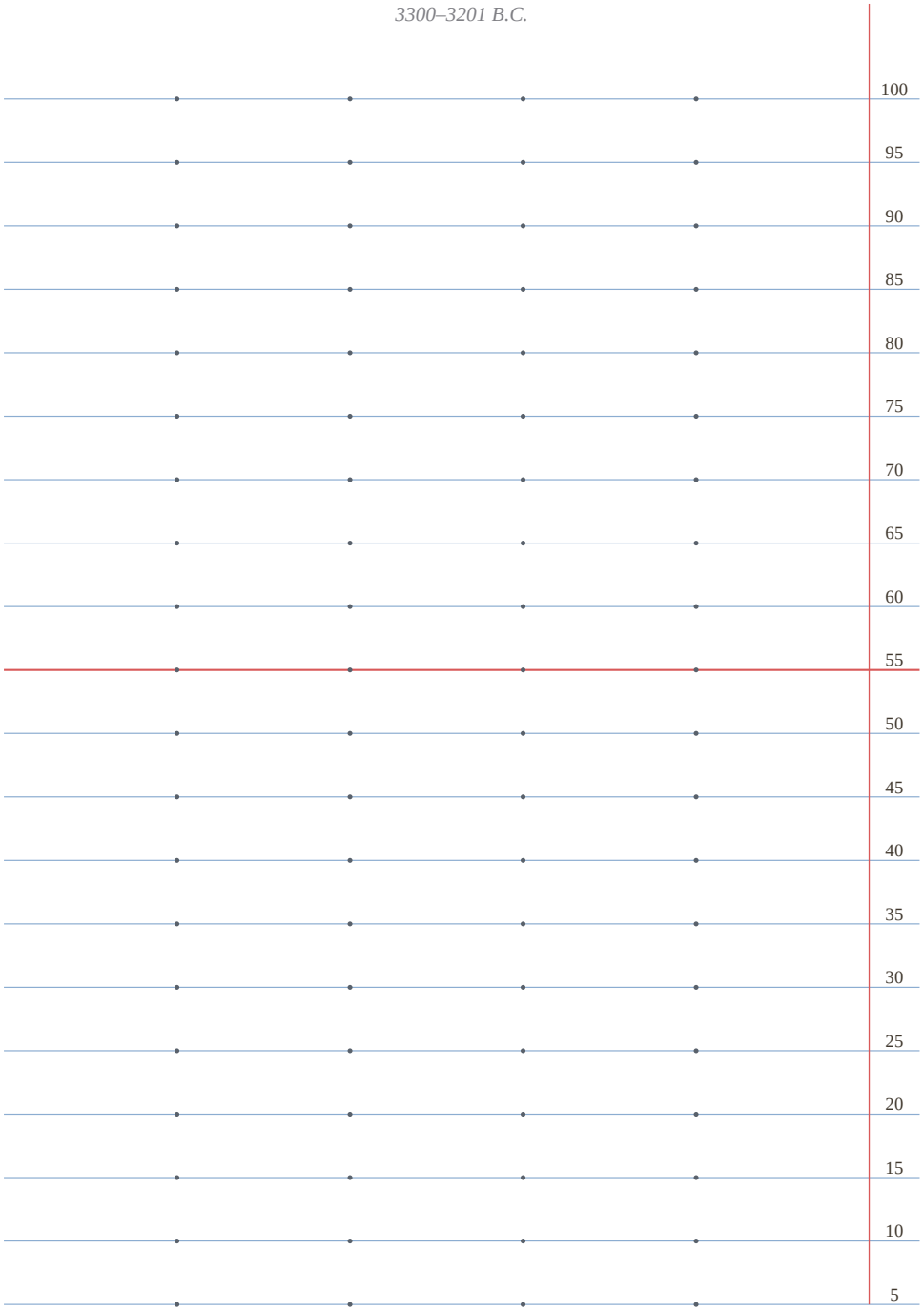
14th Century, B.C.

1400–1301 B.C.



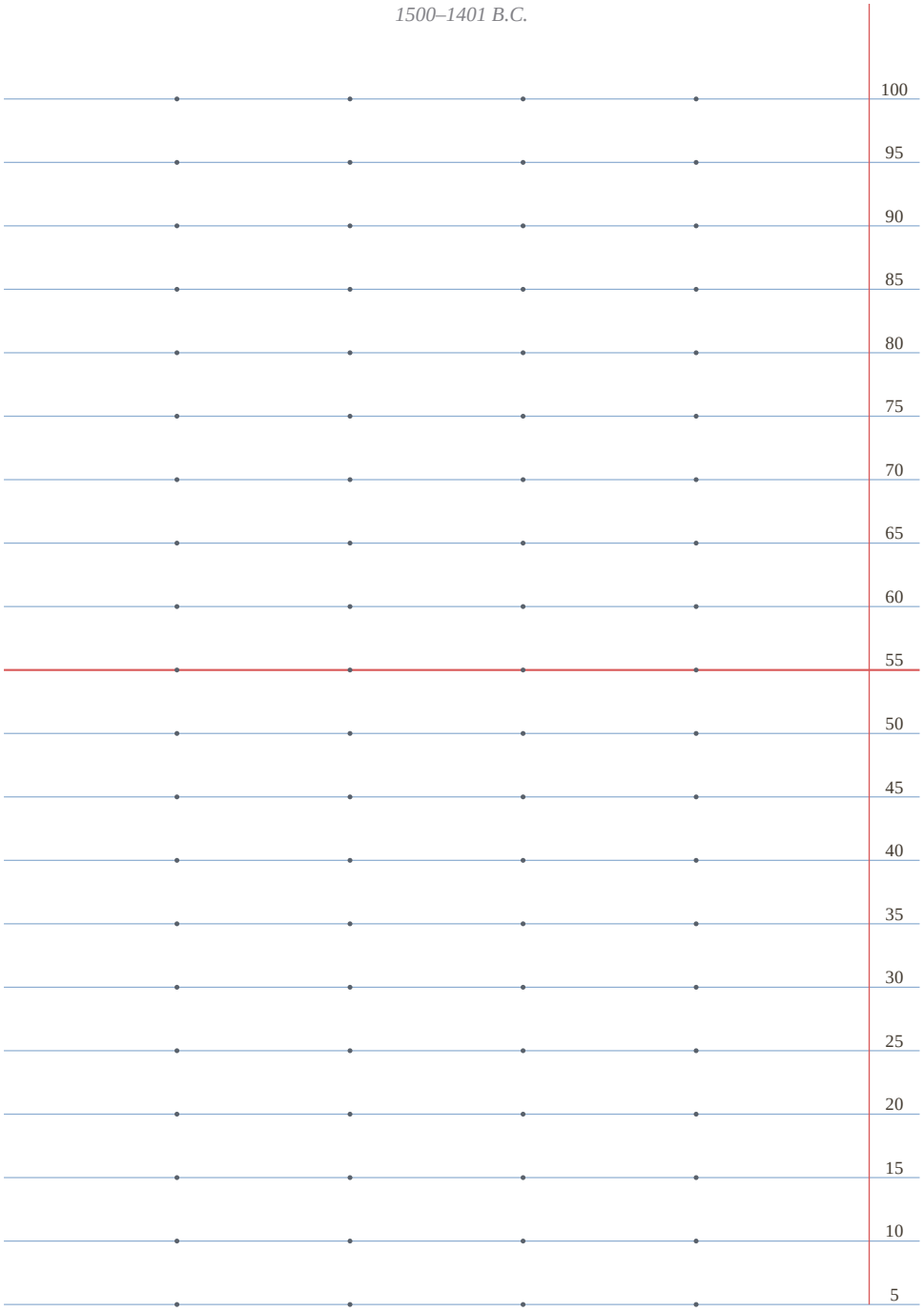
33rd Century, B.C.

3300–3201 B.C.



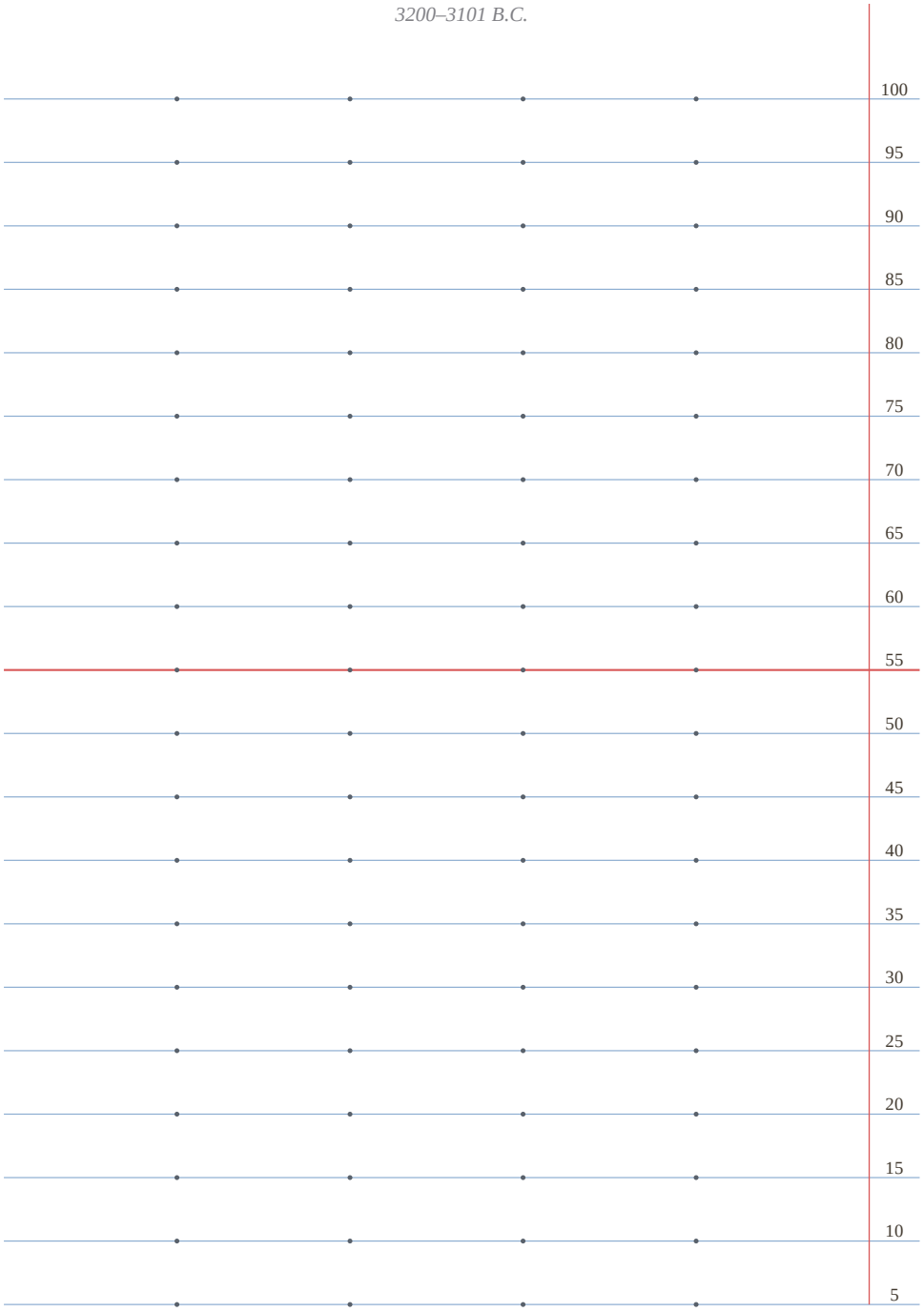
15th Century, B.C.

1500–1401 B.C.



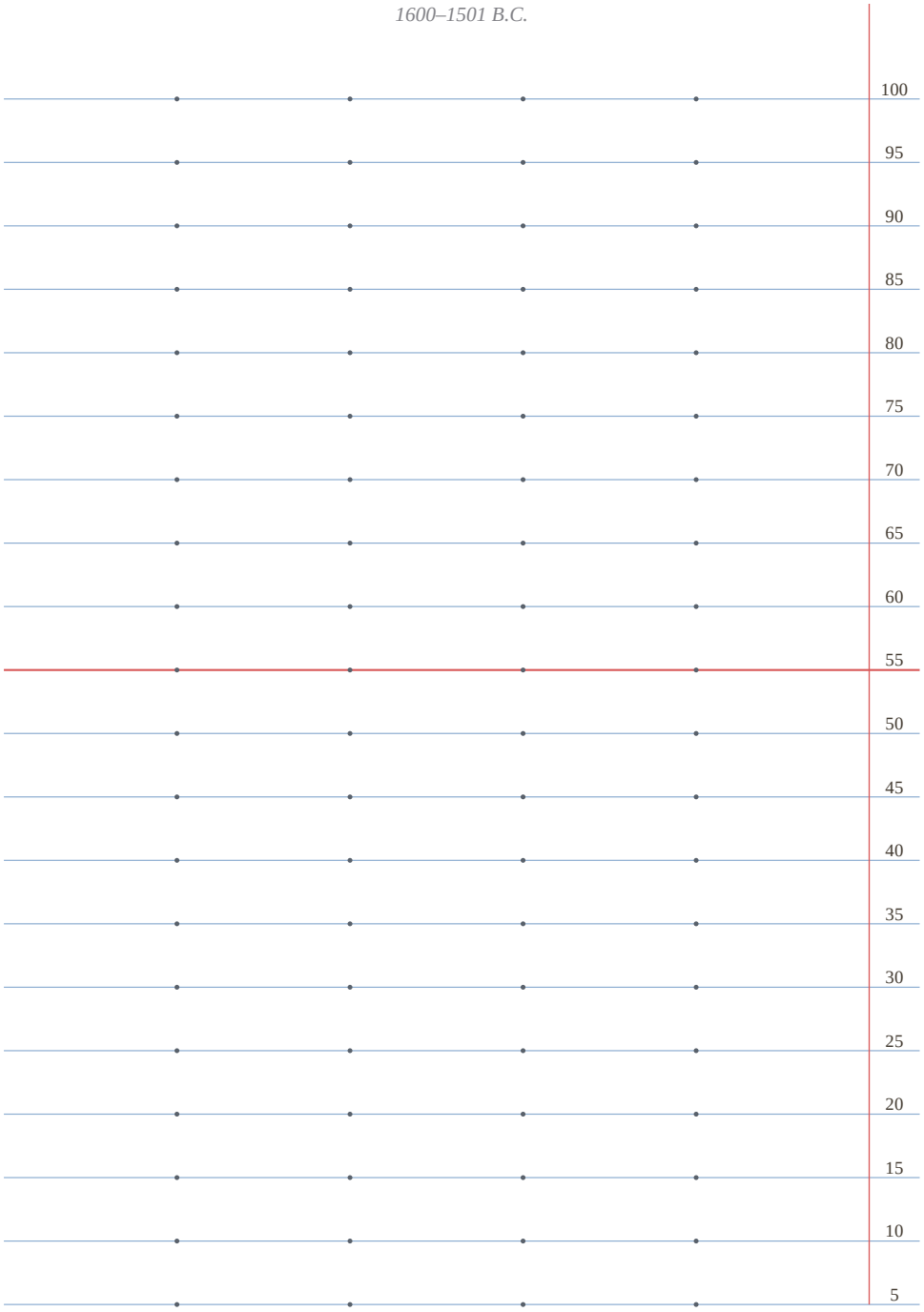
32nd Century, B.C.

3200–3101 B.C.



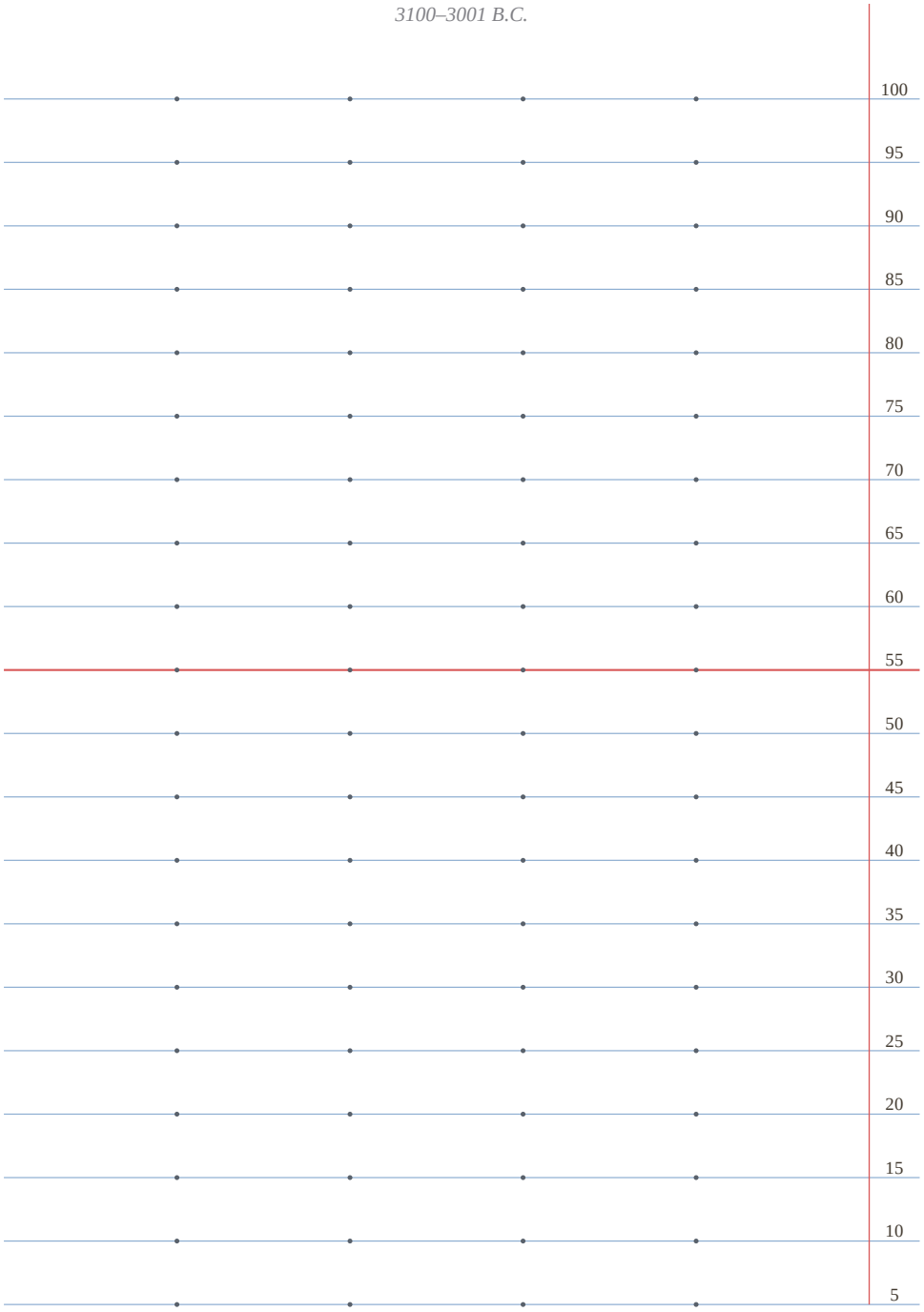
16th Century, B.C.

1600–1501 B.C.



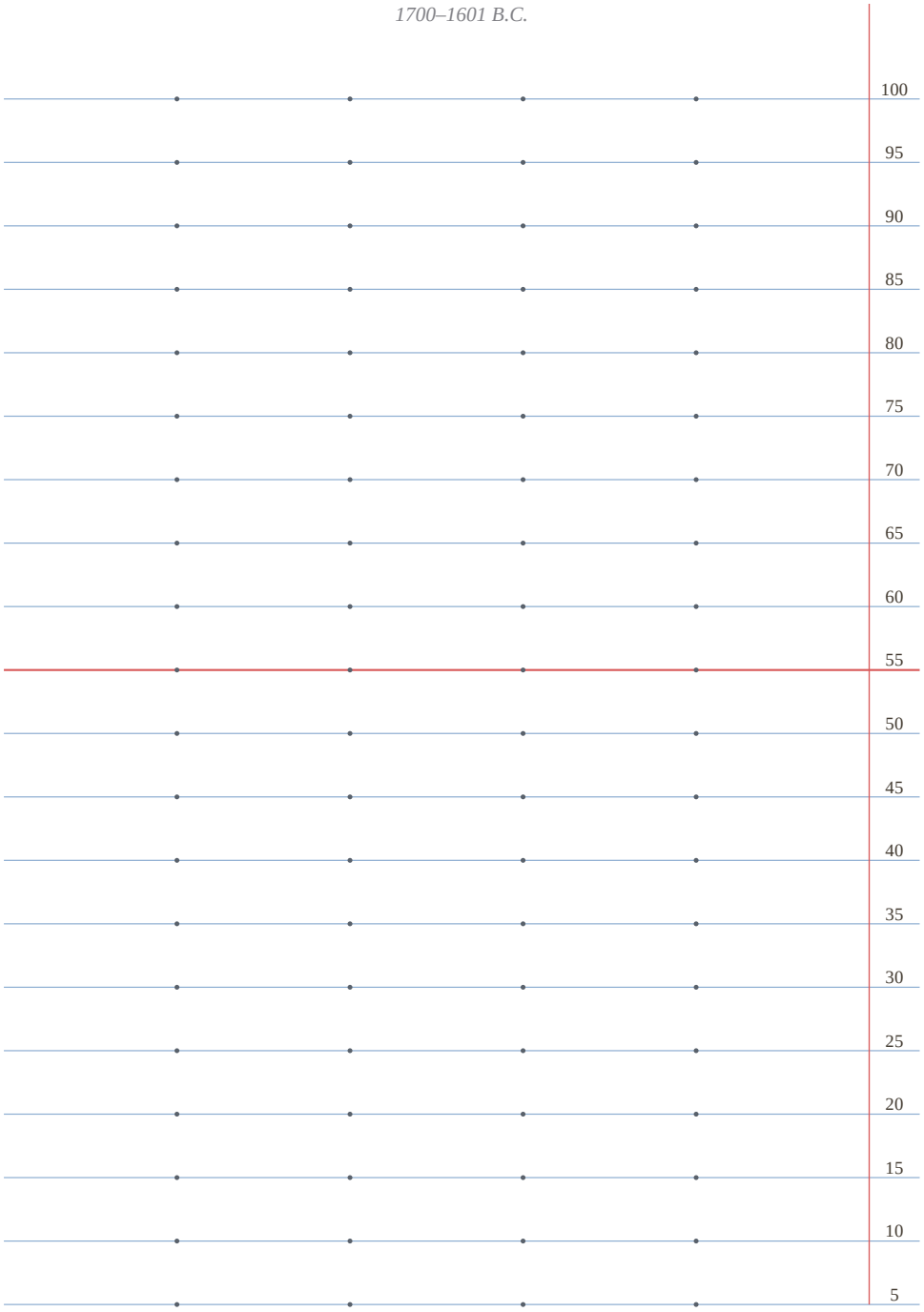
31st Century, B.C.

3100–3001 B.C.



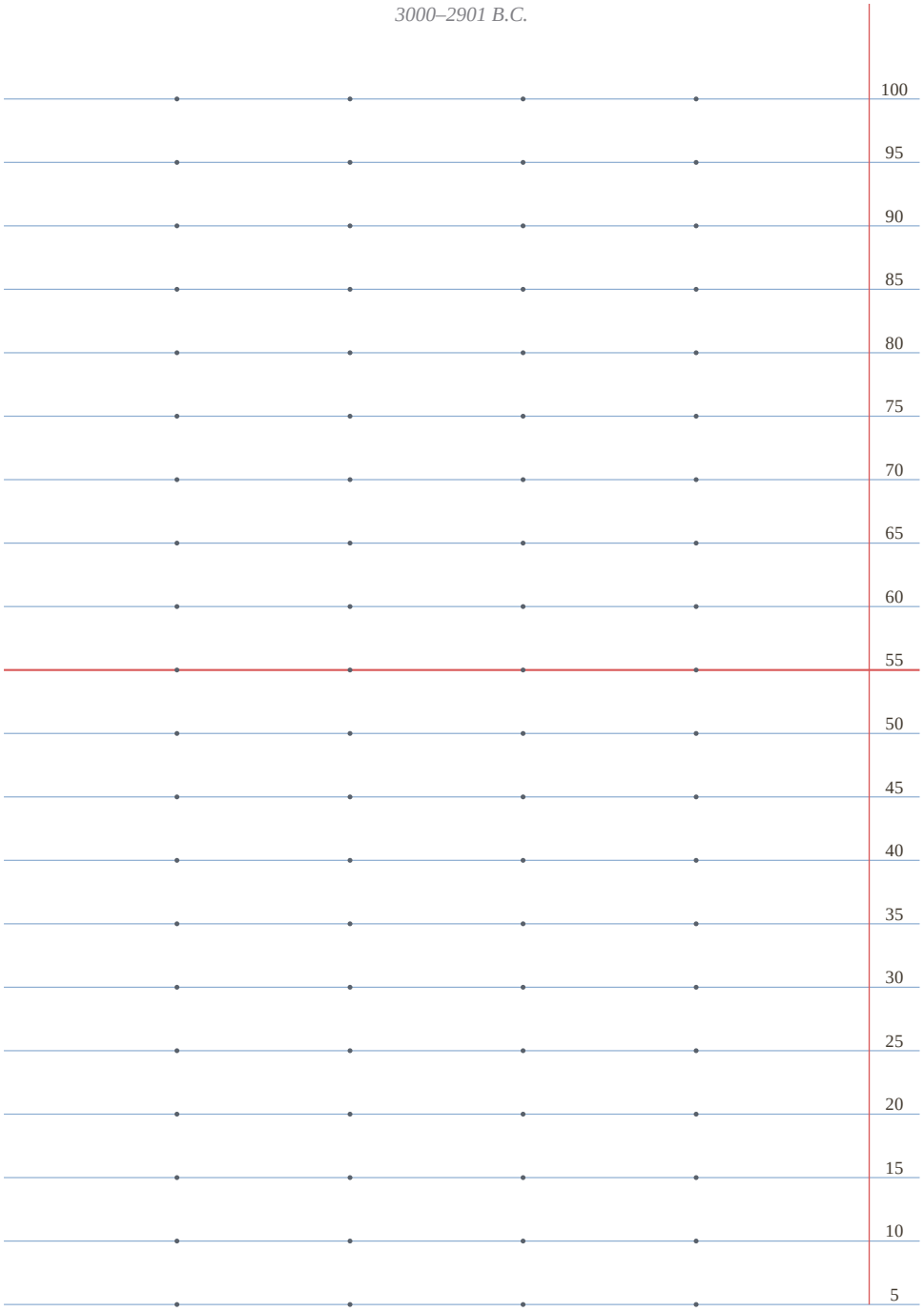
17th Century, B.C.

1700–1601 B.C.



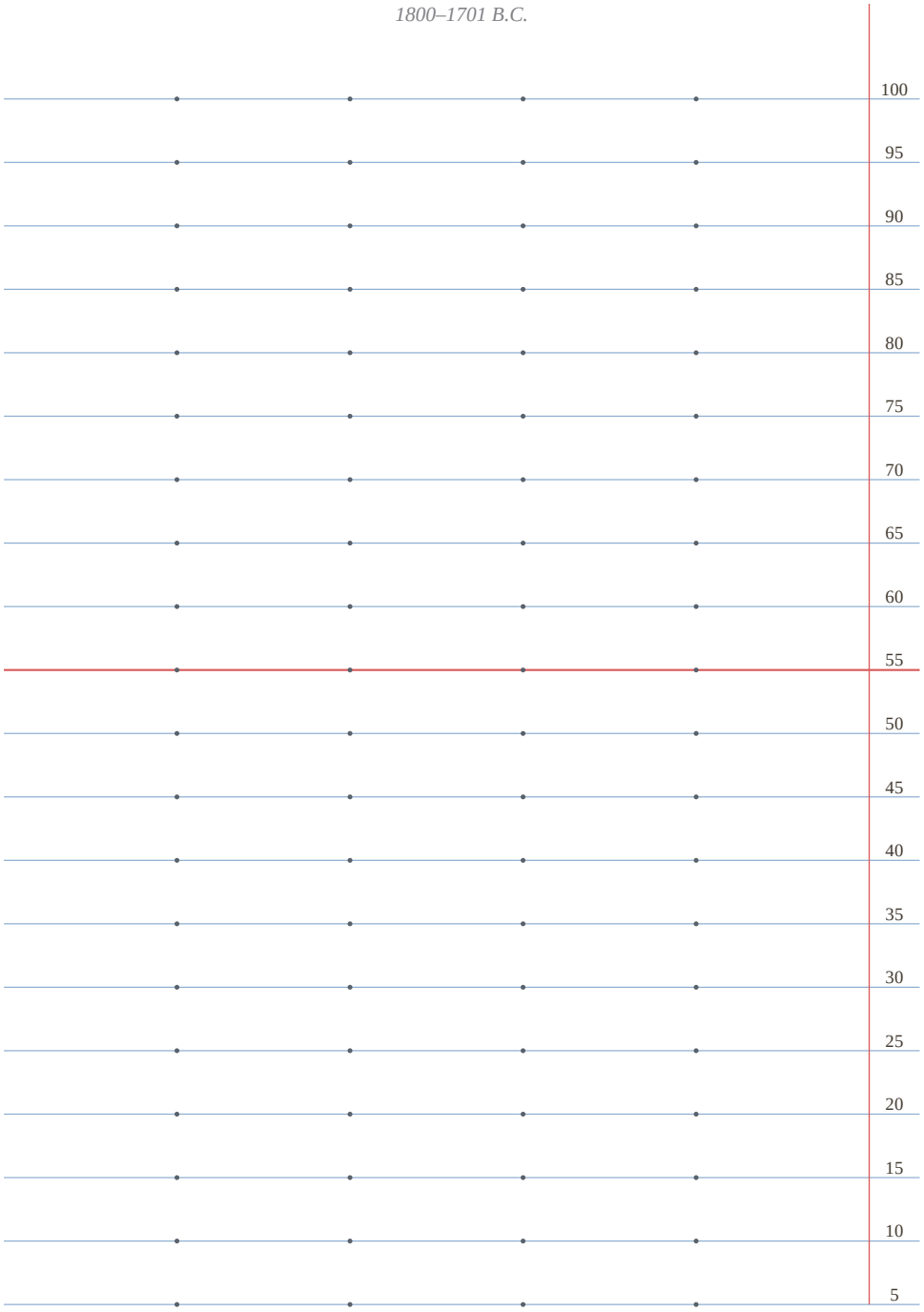
30th Century, B.C.

3000–2901 B.C.



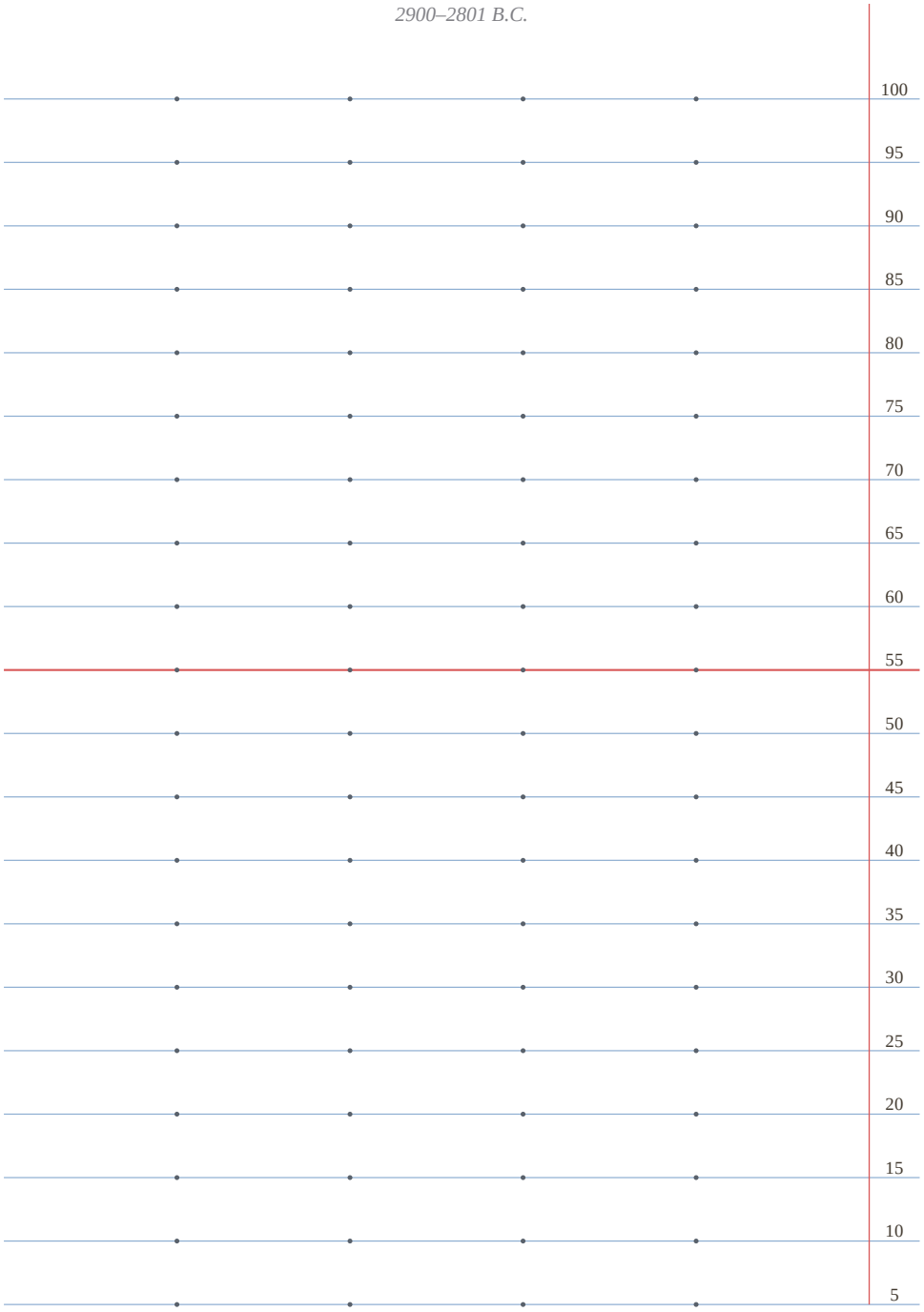
18th Century, B.C.

1800–1701 B.C.



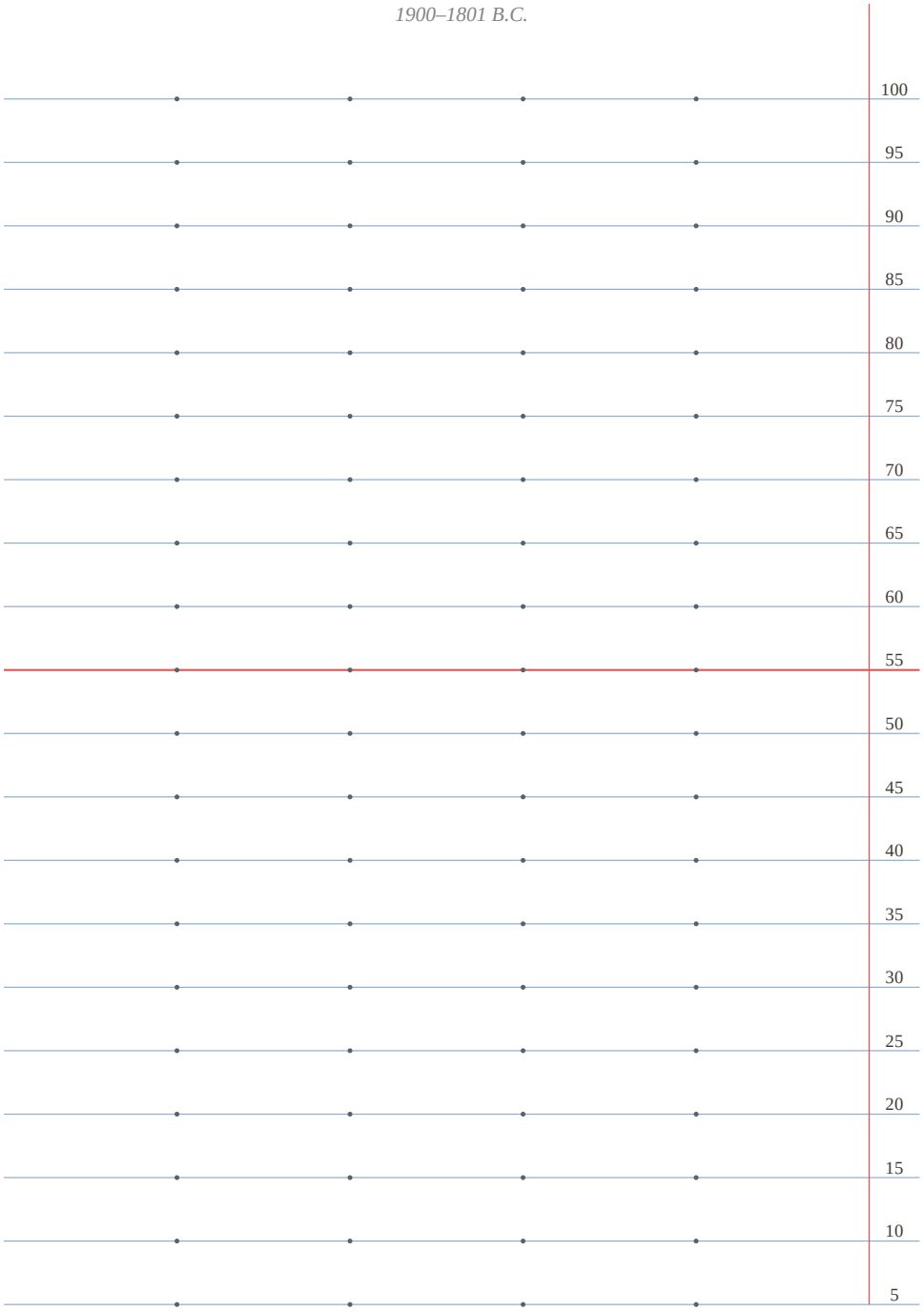
29th Century, B.C.

2900–2801 B.C.



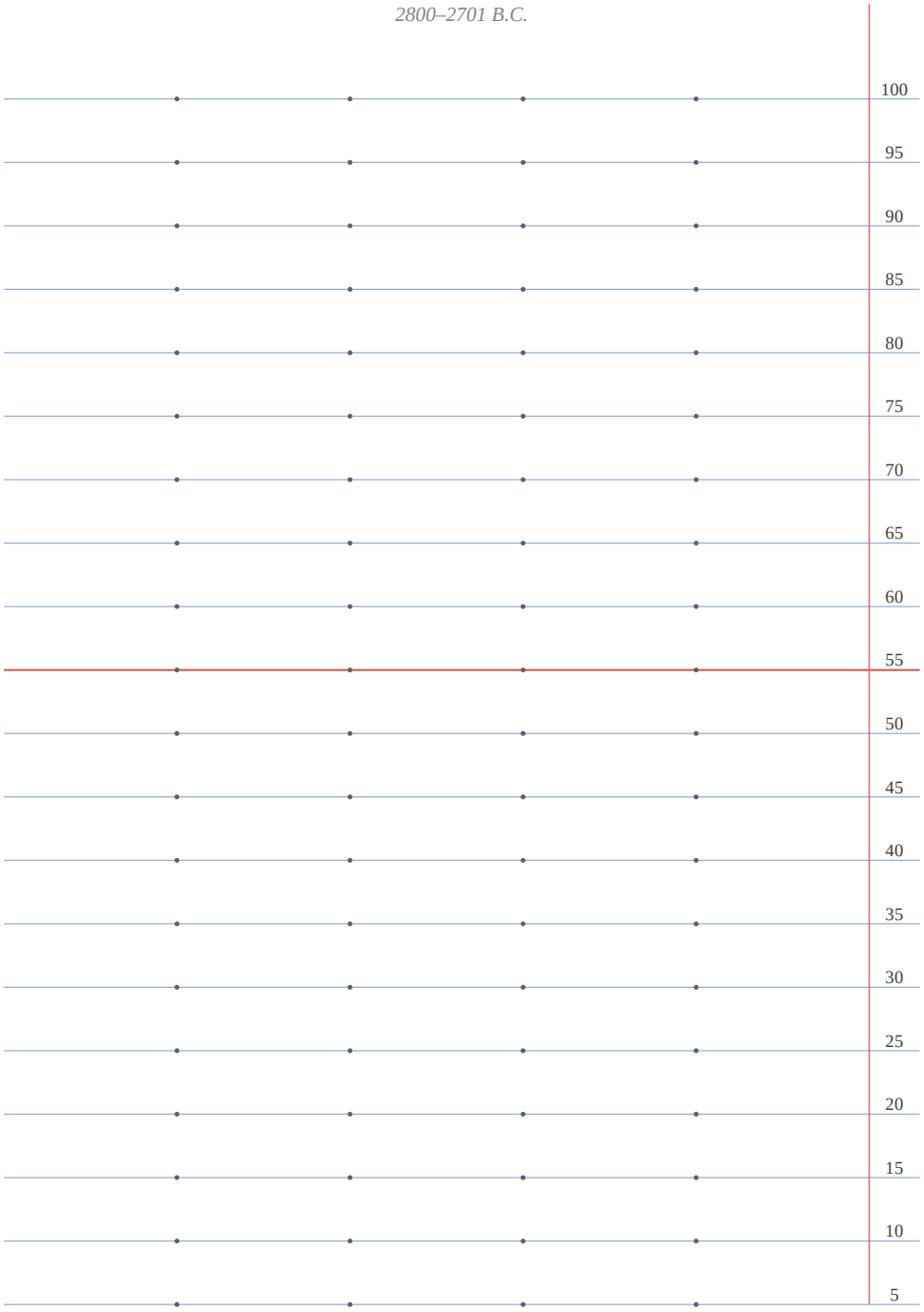
19th Century, B.C.

1900–1801 B.C.



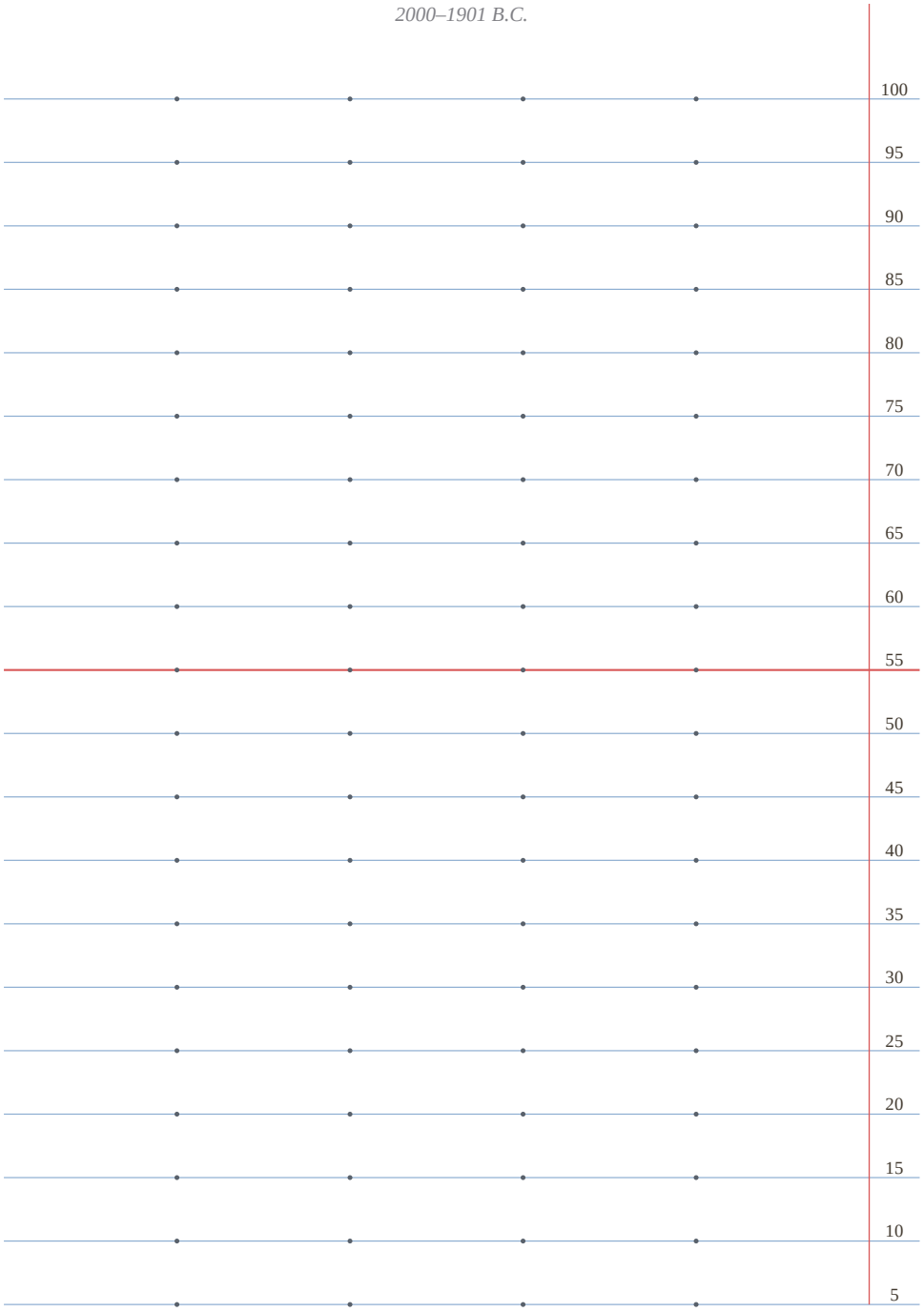
28th Century, B.C.

2800–2701 B.C.



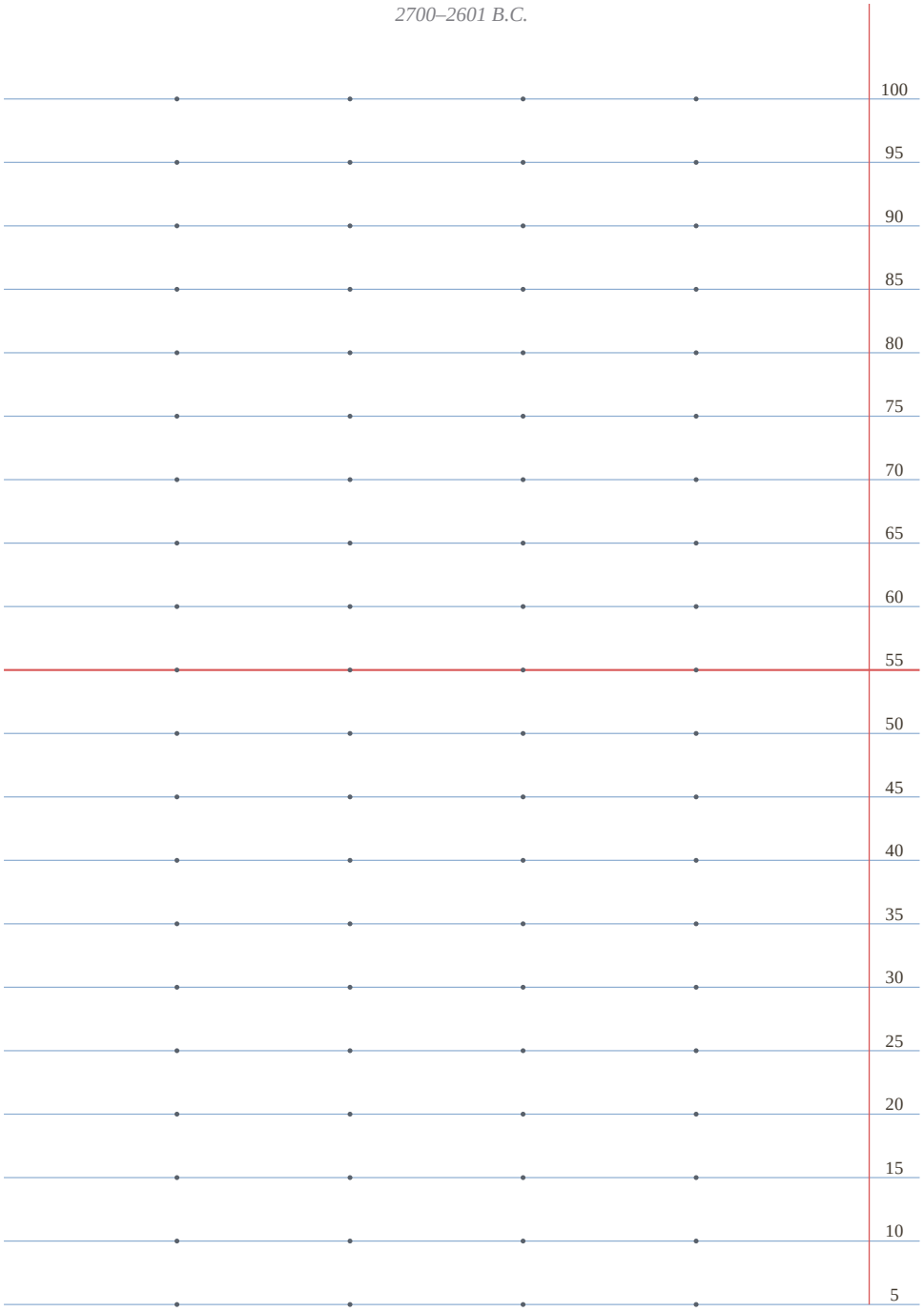
20th Century, B.C.

2000–1901 B.C.



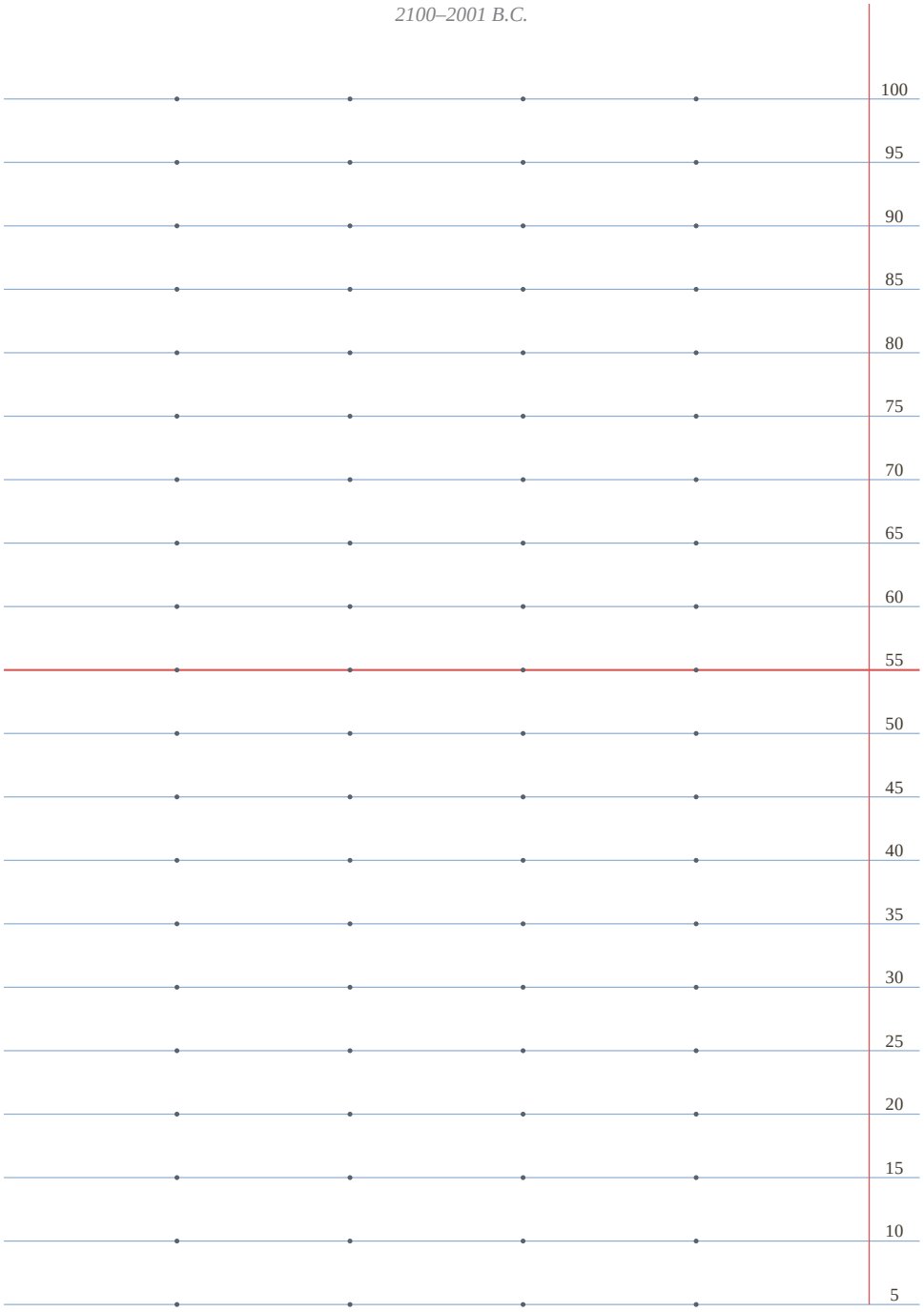
27th Century, B.C.

2700–2601 B.C.



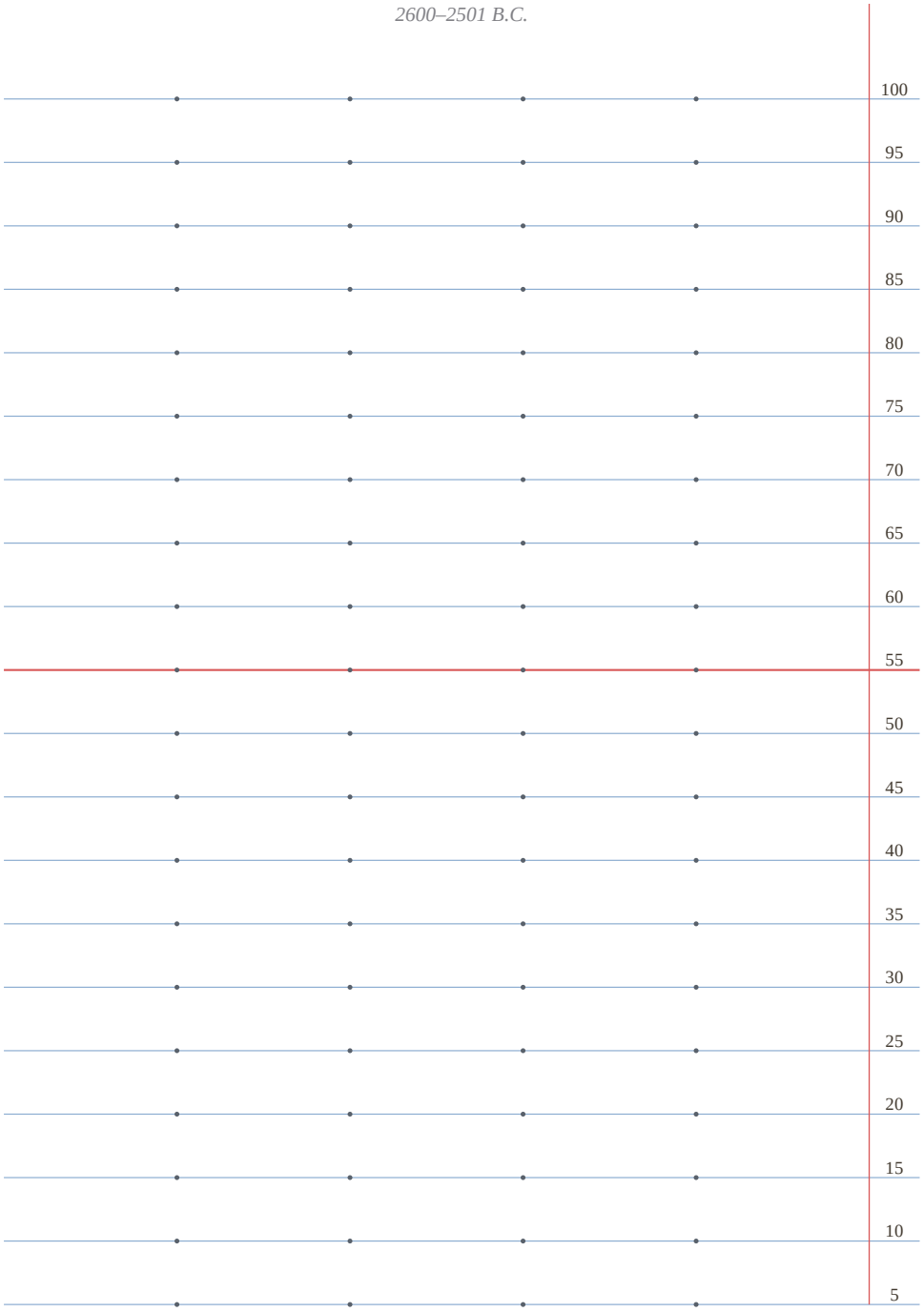
21st Century, B.C.

2100–2001 B.C.



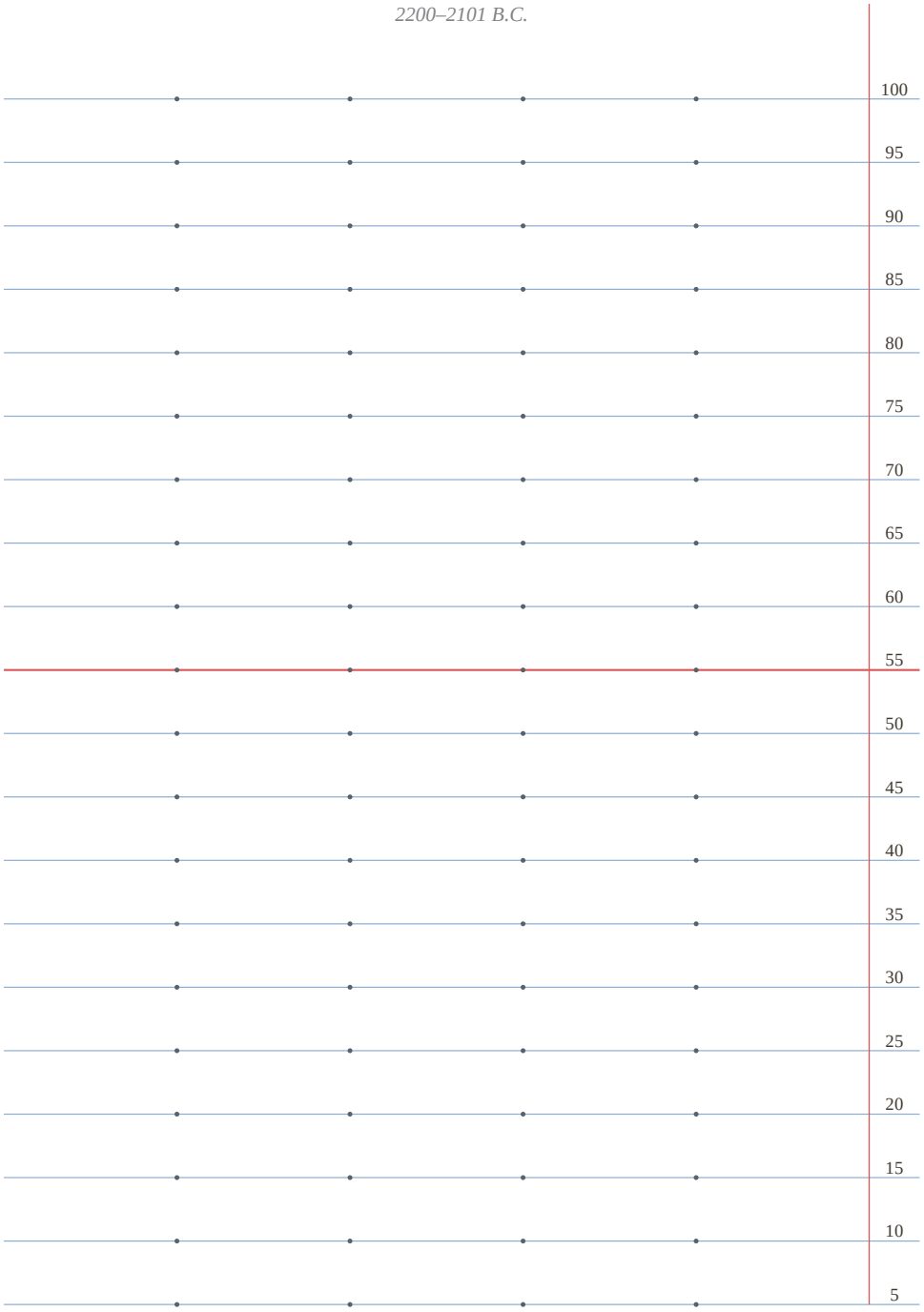
26th Century, B.C.

2600–2501 B.C.



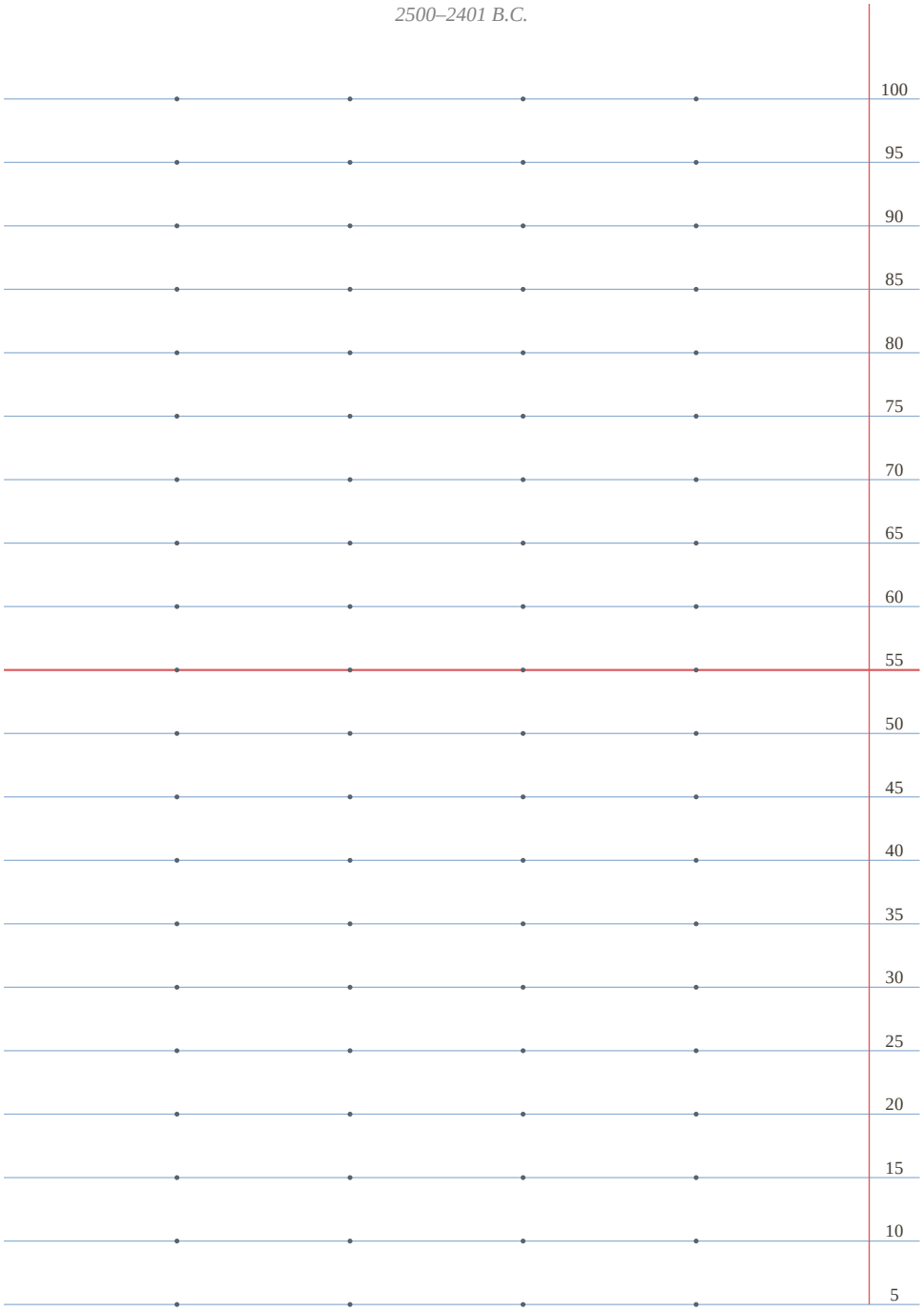
22nd Century, B.C.

2200–2101 B.C.



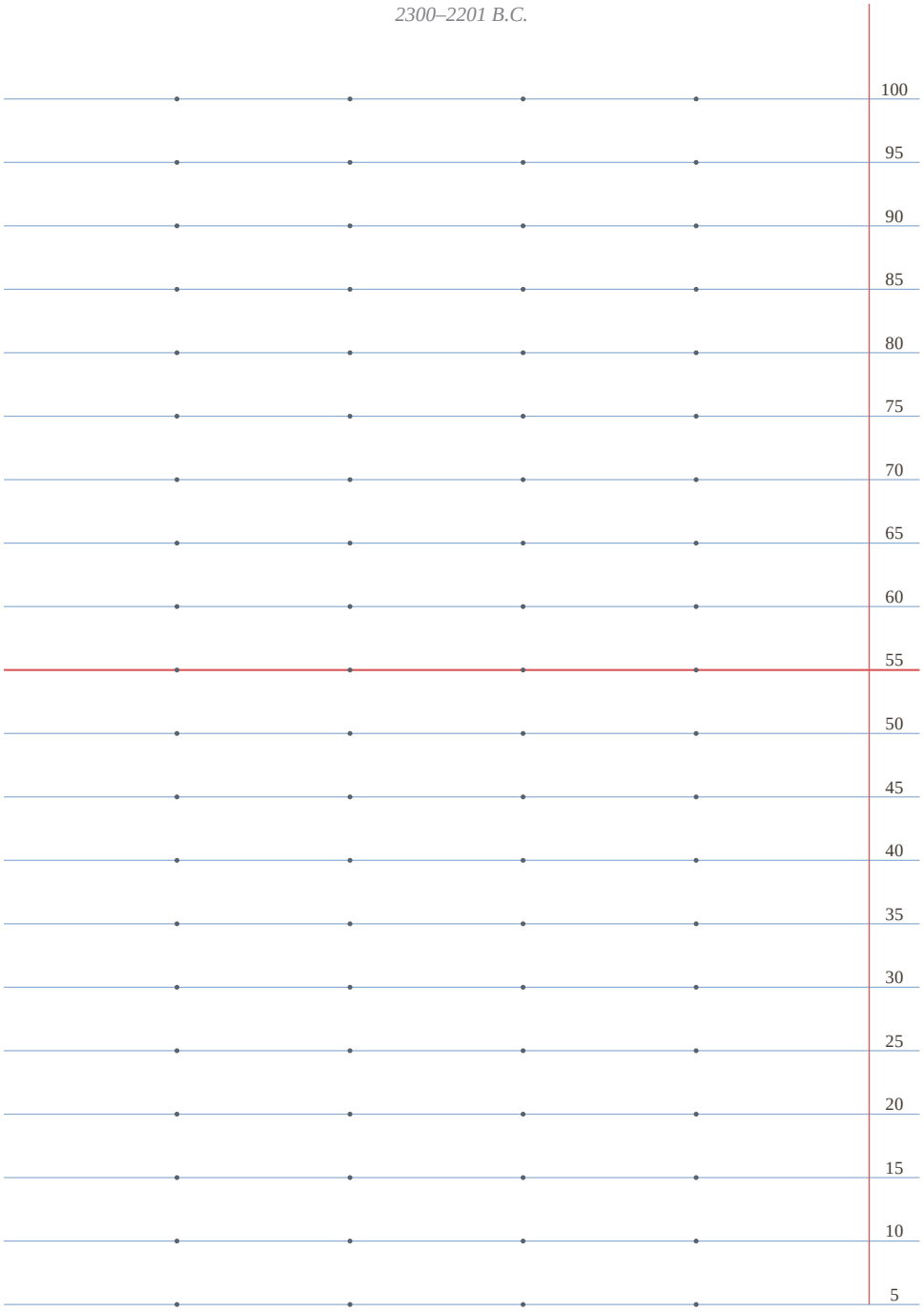
25th Century, B.C.

2500–2401 B.C.



23rd Century, B.C.

2300–2201 B.C.



24th Century, B.C.

2400–2301 B.C.

